

Plasto & Company Livestock and Property

Livestock
Ross Plasto
0428 636 289

Property Management
Emma Cenzato
0418 636 254

Raine and Horne
Residential & Rural Properties
Gary Francis
0428 459 830

Wellington & District LEADER

Covering news and views from within the Wellington, Eucharanea, Geurie, Goolma, Gollan, Mumbil, Stuart Town, Wongarbon and Yeoval districts.

Established August, 2021

\$2.50

Inc GST

No. 225

THURSDAY, March 26, 2026

ISSN 2653-2026

WELLINGTON RACE CLUB

Wellington Boot Carnival

Friday 10 April
Sunday 12 April

Man from Ironbark

- P 3

WINS open day shows off new board & staff

- P 5

Lucy features at Mitchell Library

- P 21

Inside - 8-page Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club - 2026 Wellington Boot Racing Carnival

Richest race in the West

IT'S JUST 15 days to go for the 'Richest Race in the West', the Wellington Boot - an 1100 metre race for two-year-olds with prizemoney of \$200,000.

This will be the 46th Boot Racing Carnival and the third sponsored by Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club and it's shaping up to be one of the best two-day racing carnivals organised by the Wellington Race Club.

The carnival begins with an eight-race card on Friday, April 10 - featuring the Over The Line Racing Iron Horse Handicap run over 2400 metres with prizemoney totalling over \$40,000 which attracts some of the best 'stayers' from around the state.

Then it's back to the Soldiers Club for a Chisel Barnes Show that night featuring tributes to Cold Chisel and Jimmy Barnes.

Saturday, April 11 is a racing lay-day, but all the golfers and friends will be out at Wellington Golf Course for a four-person Ambrose competition before heading to the Soldiers Club for the Wellington Boot Calcutta.

From 6pm Calcutta tickets will be for sale prior to a fun evening featuring special racing personalities including jockey legend 'Miracle' Malcolm Johnson who loves coming to the Boot weekend, and the gentleman of riding, Greg Ryan, a Wellington boy who became a champion.

With them will be NRL great, Gary Freeman.

Featuring at the Calcutta is the Tooheys Guys and Dolls Challenge open to people 18 to 30 years who will be guests of Wellington Race Club, Tooheys, Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club, Eliza Whiteley Optometry and the Wellington & District Leader.

Turn to Page 9 and read more in our 8-page 2026 Wellington Boot Showcase lift-out.



Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club general manager Stephen Hodge eagerly awaits the mammoth Boot weekend.

STUART TOWN'S MAN FROM IRONBARK FESTIVAL

Saturday 4th April 2026 (Easter Saturday)

\$2 ENTRY PER PERSON
Children 5 and Under FREE

From 9am

3 Time Aust. Bush Poet Champion Gregory North

FREE Jumping Castle & Slide - Street Parade
Beard Competition - FREE Bucking Bull - Reptile Show
Sheep Dog Trials - FREE Children's Train - Meet the Dinosaurs
Car & Bike Show - FREE Face Painting - Food Stalls
Art Exhibition - Market Stalls - Yabby Races
FREE Merry-Go-Round - Easter Egg Hunt

Live Music with Mick, Tracie & Deb

Burrendong Arboretum successful Autumn plant sale

LAST SATURDAY a large crowd headed out to the Burrendong Arboretum for the Autumn plant sale.

Besides the massive number of plants for sale, there was an all-day barbecue, a coffee van, raffle, nature walks and art stalls.

Outstanding work by the Friends of Burrendong Arboretum group, along with the staff.

There are some exciting things happening at the Arboretum that will ensure the success into the future of this incredibly important national collection of Australian plants.

Biennial Water & Sewer short phone survey underway

Council is undertaking its biennial Water Supply and Sewerage Customer Satisfaction Survey.

The survey examines overall water supply and sewerage service delivery across the Local Government Area (LGA) and forms part of Council's 2024 - 2026 Water Supply and Sewerage Customer Service Plan.

It will be conducted by external provider Micromex and residents across the LGA may receive a phone call from 02 8271 0200 inviting them to participate.

Phone numbers will be selected at random, and no personal information will be requested.

The survey will commence on March 23. Researchers are seeking a minimum of 500 participants, with the survey to be undertaken by phone using a mix of mobile and landline numbers.

Residents with direct questions about service levels who do not receive a phone call are invited to contact Council via DRC&Me, by phoning 6801 4000 or emailing council@dubbo.nsw.gov.au with their enquiry and contact details so staff can respond.

Science in action at Wellington Caves

Looking to visit the Wellington Caves with your visiting friends or relatives this Easter weekend?

You may see the palaeontology team from Flinders University who will be back at the Wellington Caves over the Easter school holidays to continue their dig which began in 2016.

They will be excavating within the 2m x 2m pit in the Cathedral Cave, and tours pass right by them.

This is a great opportunity to see science being unearthed and the palaeos in action both underground and on the surface at the wash bay near the fossil trail.

This is where they wash and sort through the

excavated dirt to find teeth, bones, and maybe even previously unknown species.

In 2023 the team published a scientific paper describing a large extinct armoured skink from fossils excavated here at Wellington Caves.

Affectionately known as 'Megachonk', this was the largest skink ever known!

To book your tour of the Caves go to:

* Online via 123 Tix

* At the Wellington Caves Visitor Experience Centre

* At Dubbo Visitor Information Centre

* Mates Rates for locals can be redeemed on booking, T&Cs apply.

Waste 2 Art Competition entries close soon

There is still time to enter the 2026 Waste 2 Art Competition.

This innovative community art competition allows schools, community groups and individuals to get involved and turn rubbish in the art.

This year's theme is 'Shrink Your Footprint.'

Waste 2 Art is a NetWaste initiative, sponsored by Access Recycling.

Entries close on Friday, April 3. All entries will be showcased in an exhibition at the Western Plains Cultural Centre from May 2 to August 9.

For more information visit: www.westernplainsculturalcentre.org/waste2art

Have YourSay

Council has a number of items currently open for public view or comment, including:

* Disability Inclusion Action Plan Survey

* 2026 Community Insights Survey

* Destination Partnership Program Review

Join the conversation and have your say now at: <https://yoursay.dubbo.nsw.gov.au/>

Stay informed. Register to follow the project, program and activity listings that are important to you at YourSay.

We're inviting the community to share feedback to help shape the Disability Inclusion Action Plan 2026-2030.

Your feedback will help guide actions that focus on:

* Creating a more liveable and inclusive community

* Ensuring service information is accessible and appropriate for people with disability

The survey plays an important role in informing the plan and is now open and closes on Monday, April 20.

Take part and help shape a more inclusive future.

Josh Black

Worst ever free trade agreement for Australian red meat industry to date

THE AUSTRALIAN red meat industry says the Federal Government has badly let the sector down, signing an extremely disappointing free trade deal with the European Union that falls far short of what Australia needed and expected.

Australia's red meat industry is devastated that the Federal Government signed an FTA that falls well short of delivering a significant increase in market access, despite repeatedly indicating it would not sign a bad deal.

While the incremental increase in quota access has been noted, the outcome is well below the Australian Government's own objectives, let alone stakeholder expectations.

Unfortunately, the deal announced on Tuesday by Australian Prime Minister Anthony Albanese and the President of the EU Commission Ursula von der Leyen will see the continuation of disproportionately low quotas for red meat, placing Australia at an ongoing competitive disadvantage in the highly valued EU market, according to Australia-EU Red Meat Market Access Taskforce chair, Andrew McDonald.

"Australia's red meat sector has been profoundly let down by this outcome," Mr McDonald, said.

"The Australian red meat industry has been crystal clear that the FTA negotiations were the ideal mechanism to finally address the EU's punitive and highly discriminatory import regime.

"Yet the agreement delivers just 30,600 tonnes carcase weight (cwt) of beef access over the next 10 years, when a minimum of 50,000 tonnes (cwt) was required simply to be in line with what the EU has

offered our competitors.

"On sheepmeat and goatmeat, the result is equally disappointing: 25,000 tonnes (cwt) over seven years, despite Australian industry requesting a minimum of 67,000 tonnes cwt.

"This stands in stark contrast to New Zealand's access of 163,769 tonnes, which is an outrageous discrepancy.

"To land a deal so far below what other suppliers have secured is genuinely bewildering.

"The agreement is a long way from anything resembling 'free and fair trade', particularly given Australia already provides the EU with quota and tariff free access for meat products like pork, while the AEU FTA locks in perpetual volume constraints on Australian red meat entering the EU.

"This outcome also sits uneasily beside the EU's rhetoric of providing 'a level playing field for all' and its claims that Australia is a 'like-minded' partner. In practice, this agreement delivers neither fairness nor reciprocity.

"This is unquestionably a missed opportunity for Australia's red meat producers, processors and exporters.

"It will limit our sector's ability to diversify into a market of 27 countries with strong and ongoing demand for imported meat.

"It will also deprive most of the EU's 450 million consumers of the chance to choose highquality, sustainable Australian red meat products.

"The EU's inability to reform its deeply protectionist trade regime ultimately prevented the delivery of a good deal."

But NSW welcomes 'landmark Australia EU trade deal'

THE MINNS Labor Government has welcomed the conclusion of negotiations on a Free Trade Agreement between Australia and the European Union, a landmark deal that with the potential to unlock new opportunities for NSW exporters and strengthen the state's ability to attract European investment and businesses.

Contrary to the Australian Red Meat Industry's disappointment, NSW Minister for Industry and Trade, Anoulack Chanthivong said the agreement opened the door to one of the world's largest and most sophisticated economies, helping local businesses grow, create jobs and stay competitive in a changing global economy.

"From farmers and food producers, to manufacturers, tech start-ups and clean energy firms, the deal creates new opportunities for NSW businesses to reach millions of new customers overseas, while reducing the red tape that make exporting harder," he said.

The European Union accounts for almost 16 per cent of global trade, making it a powerful

Now secure Digital Birth Certificates available

IN AN Australian first, people born in NSW who are aged 16 to 21 now have the option to set up a Digital Birth Certificate, making it easier to access their identification.

The new digital document is available statewide, has been designed to international security standards and can be set up via the Service NSW app. This opt-in Digital Birth Certificate provides a secure way to access this essential document and will allow greater control over information being shared.

The first group of people to be eligible to apply are 16 to 21-year-olds born in NSW, who hold a NSW photo card or driver licence.

Young adults will now be able to use their Digital Birth Certificate to verify their identity and apply for a range of licences and certifications needed to start a job including Responsible Service of Alcohol (RSA), Responsible Conduct of Gambling (RCG), as well as other workforce licences.

Over time, the Digital Birth Certificate will allow for wider integrated transactions to improve the way people interact with NSW Government services and give people greater control over what information they share. Service NSW and the NSW Registry of Births, Deaths and Marriages are engaging community and industry leaders to work with businesses, schools, clubs and sporting organisations, to look at opportunities to make it easier to register and apply for the services people need using the new digital tool.

economic partner for NSW. For regional NSW farmers and food producers, this agreement means new pathways to reach European consumers who value quality and sustainability – areas where NSW excels. Many food and beverage producers will have better access than ever.

"The agreement also strengthens ties in fast-growing industries like critical minerals for clean energy, digital technology and advanced manufacturing, helping NSW businesses plug into global supply chains and attract new investment.

"Importantly, the deal is expected to strengthen NSW's attractiveness as a destination for European investment, supporting job creation, innovation and long-term economic growth."

The Minns Labor Government will continue to support businesses to take advantage of new trade opportunities and attract strategic investment in line with the NSW Trade and Investment Strategy 2035, the state's 10year plan to grow and diversify exports and attract global investment.

Wellington & District LEADER

In Memory of Beryl O'Brien

Covering news and views particularly from within the Wellington region, which now runs from Euchareena to Elong Elong within Dubbo Regional Council Local Government Area.

Wellington & District Leader is independently published locally by Mark Griggs and Sharon Wilson trading as Wellington District Leader, 14 Nancarrow Lane, Wellington, NSW, 2820, ABN: 26847723165 and printed by Gilgandra Newspapers, another independent and both members of CPNSW.

Editor: Mark Griggs
0456 940 999

email: mark@wdleader.news

Advertising Manager
Sharon Wilson
0407 935 998

email: sharon@wdleader.news

Community input and feedback is welcomed. Story leads, prepared articles and photographs can be forwarded to the publisher.

NOTICE TO ADVERTISERS, LETTER WRITERS AND READERS
The publisher accepts no responsibility for any advertisement, notice, letter or opinion published in this newspaper. Any advertisement, notice, letter or opinion published is published at the risk of the contributor who accepts liability for any intended publication. All such contributors by forwarding advertisements, notices, letters or opinions agree to indemnify the material is accurate and is neither deceptive or misleading, in breach of copyright, defamatory or in breach of any other laws and regulations.
In lodging an advertisement with us you agree that we may publish the advertisement on our website. The general terms and conditions that apply to publication of advertisements in our publication apply also to publication of material on our website. Advertising conditions of the *Wellington & District Leader* are available on request by phoning 0407 935 998.

Obituaries of our loved ones are welcomed for publication in the
Wellington & District Leader
Contact: mark@wdleader.news

Easter Saturday better than ever at Stuart Town’s Man from Ironbark Festival

THIS YEAR’S Man from Ironbark Festival has been designed to create lasting memories for everyone attending. All roads lead to Stuart Town this Easter Saturday, April 4, as the highly anticipated Festival returns, promising more excitement and a larger scale than ever before.

Welcoming visitors back to both the recreation ground and, for the first time in over five years, the main street for an expanded celebration, plus an affordable entry fee of just \$2 per person - and free admission for children aged five and under - the festival provides exceptional value and a welcoming atmosphere for families and individuals alike.

Whether you have been coming for years or are joining the fun for the first time, this festival is sure to delight.

Visitors can look forward to a wide range of activities and entertainment, including a free jumping castle and slide, a lively street parade (featuring cars, motorbikes, go carts and dressed up Ride On Mowers), and market stalls galore offering unique goods.

For those seeking a bit of friendly competition, there will be yabby races and a beard competition, along with a free bucking bull ride and a free children’s train.

Animal lovers can enjoy a reptile show and the chance to meet the dinosaurs, while car and bike enthusiasts will appreciate the car and bike show.

Children will enjoy free face painting, an Easter egg hunt bigger than ever and always eagerly awaited, and a free merry-go-round.



In addition, there will be food stalls to satisfy every appetite, an art exhibition, a busking competition, and sheep dog trials.

Live music in Moxon Park will showcase Wellington’s favourites: Mick Austin, Tracie Charman, and Debbie Goninon.



First street parade in five years.

A special feature at this year’s festival will be an appearance by three-time Australian Bush Poetry Champion Gregory North.

Gregory is currently traveling around the country with his Banjo Patterson

“Banjo 125” tour, but we are excited to announce that he will be making a special visit to our event.

Throughout the day, Gregory will be giving three performances, offering festival-goers a wonderful opportunity to



Easter Egg hunt attracts hundreds of eager chocolate chasers.

experience his acclaimed poetry live.

We hope you can join us for this unique highlight and enjoy the vibrant storytelling and energy Gregory brings to each of his shows.

With so much to see and do, Stuart Town’s Man from Ironbark Festival is the perfect way to celebrate Easter Saturday with family and friends.

New Workshop: *Why Die?*

Sunday 29th March
10am to 2pm

All welcome! Please call 6845 4661



One Stop Automotive Shop

We Service New Cars and you get
to keep the Warranty

We offer Pink/Green/Blue slips
Servicing new and old vehicles

Daniel Blackhall: 02 6845 4062 | 0439 589 860
Email: onestopautomotiveshop@hotmail.com
36A Gisborne Street, Wellington



ALL WELCOME Join us for Sunday Service

Sunday 9:30am. Pastor Rudolph Kock
Mobile 0475799036

*Share your copy of this paper,
let everyone have a good read*

Easter Specials listed are available from Thursday 2nd through Monday 6th April.



30PK GREAT
NORTHERN|SUPER
CRISP \$59.00



10 PK BUNDY|4.8%
\$49.00 EACH



GORDON'S PINK
GIN|6X4X330ML
BOTTLES \$120.00



BUFFALO TRACE
WHISKEY \$60.00

Easter
OPEN HOURS

GRAND HOTEL BOTTLE SHOP
WELLINGTON

THURSDAY 2ND APRIL - 11PM - 8PM

FRIDAY 3RD APRIL - CLOSED

SATURDAY 4TH APRIL - 10AM - 8PM

SUNDAY 5TH APRIL - 12PM - 5PM

MONDAY 6TH APRIL - 11AM - 4PM

MASS IN CATHEDRAL CAVE

MARCH 17, 1854.

Researched by Marie Hoffman.

ON 17th March, 1854, French Priest, Father Bushawa, held a St. Patrick’s Day Mass within the Cathedral Cave. The Service was attended by a large number of local residents.

Father Bushawa, who was the local priest attempted to rename the cave to ‘St. Patrick’s Cave’, however the name never caught on.

Within the Cathedral Cave there are a number of references that point to a history of religious connection.

‘The Altar’ is a spectacular crystal formation located Cathedral Chamber that served as a backdrop for many religious services.

Formed from calcite crystal ‘the Altar’ includes an almost perfect representation of a pulpit, baptism bath, and pipe organs.

St. Patrick’s Church held a Mass to commemorate the 150th Anniversary of the original Mass on June 20, 2004.

The programme (published) is from the Wellington Caves History Section, preserved through the development of Dubbo Regional Council’s cultural collections which is an ongoing process.

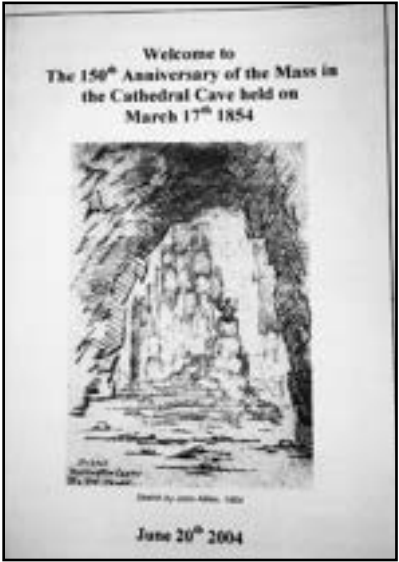
I was curious to learn more about the Mass and found an article in the Freeman’s Journal (Sydney N.S.W.)

Saturday 24 December 1898, which also gives an account of the Mass.

‘A RETROSPECT OF WELLINGTON.’

(By Pinxit)
“Father Bushawa, I remember visiting the Lower Macquarie in or about the year 1849.

It was no pleasure trip in those days to explore the Backblocks.



Father McCarthy was the next to visit Wellington.

He was stationed in Mudgee and made several journeys over.

I think it was the year 1852 that the late Bishop Polding, accompanied by Abbot Gregory, visited the old town, putting up at the late Mr. N Hyeronimus’s, and celebrating Mass in Tom Sullivan’s house.

It was during this visit that Bishop Polding consecrated the old burial ground on the banks of Curra Creek, in which sleep many of the old pioneers who have done so much to develop the resources of the then unexplored interior of this colony.

I think it was in 1853 that Father Coomben paid a couple of visits from Tamworth, and on St. Patrick’s Day celebrated Mass in the Wellington Caves, when nearly the whole own turned out to be present at the ceremony.

I was only a little chap then, but old enough to assist Pat Reidy to serve Mass.

I remember there was a little black native girl christened the same day.”

BELOW IS the text from my speech in Parliament I gave this week on the fuel crisis and the closure of the Great Western Highway.

“The people of the Central West are being treated like second-class citizens, and we’ve had enough.

Our region is in an unprecedented state of economic siege caused by a double failure of infrastructure and essential fuel supply that is threatening the food bowl of our nation and the survival of our businesses.

Right now, farmers are staring at empty diesel tanks, at the very time that seeds need to hit the soil.

If this government cannot even secure the fuel needed to sow a crop, it’s failed its most basic duty to the Australian people. Let me be clear: if our farmers cannot plant, this nation does not eat.

But the pain doesn’t end at the pump.

The catastrophic indefinite closure of the Great Western Highway at Victoria Pass is also an absolute disaster.

In the Hartley Valley and around our region, local businesses are being smashed.

They’re watching their customer traffic vanish, their bookings dry up and diversions destroy their livelihoods.

From Lithgow to the Darling Causeway, the diversion roads are not built to carry the extra heavy traffic. It is a recipe for tragedy.

The Great Western Highway is not fit for purpose.

We are done with the band-aid solutions in the forever roadworks.

We are done with waiting and being told to be resilient.

Enough is enough.

I call on the government to immediately guarantee country Australia’s fuel supply and provide a support package for all the businesses affected by this infuriating and entirely foreseeable failure of a bridge built by a convict chain gang in the 1830s.”

Available grants

SUPPORTING FARMERS FACING HARDSHIP

The Federal Government has introduced a new Drought Hardship Loan designed to help with short-term operating costs as farmers face longer-term droughts.

The loan will enable farmers who have been affected by drought for at least 24 months and expect to be impacted for another season, to borrow up to \$250,000.

The loan duration will be five years, with



interest incurred, but repayments fully deferred for the first two years.

To extend relief to existing RIC loan customers, interest rates on existing RIC loans will be held at 5.18% for another six months from 1 February, 2026.

The new Drought Hardship Loan is delivered through the Regional Investment Corporation and you can register your interest at <https://www.ric.gov.au/new-loans>

STRENGTHENING RURAL COMMUNITIES – SMALL & VITAL

Foundation for Rural Regional Renewal
The Strengthening Rural Communities (SRC)
Small & Vital stream gives small remote, rural and regional communities across Australia the opportunity to access funds for a broad range of initiatives that directly and clearly benefit local communities.

Small grants up to \$10,000 are available for a broad range of grassroots, community-led initiatives that directly and clearly benefit local communities with a preference for smaller communities (populations less than 15,000).

The timeframe to deliver these projects is up to 12 months.

Program Guidelines:
<https://frrr.org.au/funding/src-small-vital/#program-guidelines>

Round 28 Closes: 24 March, 2026 at 5pm

FUNDING OPEN FOR REGIONAL EVENTS

If you’re planning an event, now is a great time to apply for NSW Government funding.

These grants help grow local events, bring more visitors to our towns and support our local economies.

I encourage community groups and organisers to take a look and apply via the NSW Government website: www.nsw.gov.au/grants-and-funding/regional-events-and-partnerships
Closes: 30 March 2026 at 4pm

Did you know 82% of people say

PRINT ADS are STILL the most

trusted form of advertising for making

purchasing decisions.



with Mathew Dickerson, Axxis Comworld

IT WAS almost 10 years ago when we found ourselves doing laps of the same suburban streets, again and again, for reasons that had very little to do with getting anywhere.

Our second daughter was closing in on her required 120 hours of supervised driving - the golden ticket to sitting her driving test and earning those coveted red P plates.

Finding time was one thing; finding the enthusiasm to sit in the passenger seat while a learner navigated roundabouts was another.

Then, quite unexpectedly, help arrived - from a mobile game.

Pokémon Go had burst onto the scene, turning ordinary streets into treasure maps filled with digital creatures. Our third child, a game-loving son, was completely hooked. The only problem? There’s only so far you can chase imaginary monsters while on foot.

He needed a faster mode of transport.

It would be silly to ask your parents to drive while you captured superimposed creatures, unless, of course, your big sister needed more driving hours.

Suddenly, we had the perfect arrangement.

One child eager to drive, another eager to hunt Pokémon, and one slightly weary parent along for the ride.

We’d cruise slowly through parks, past shops, around neighbourhood blocks - our daughter gaining experience behind the wheel while our son sat glued to his phone in the back seat.

What we didn’t realise at the time was that scenes like ours were quietly building something much bigger.

Fast forward to today, and those countless hours of wandering, scanning, and pointing smartphones at the world have been repurposed into something surprisingly practical: helping robots deliver your dinner.

Behind the scenes, the technology that powered Pokémon Go didn’t just place cartoon creatures on your screen. It was also learning what the real world looks like - collecting billions of images from different angles, lighting conditions, and locations.

Every time a player paused to capture a Pokémon or scan a landmark, they were contributing to a massive visual map of the

world.

Now, that same dataset is being used to train a new generation of delivery robots.

GPS gives a delivery robot a view from above, but the Pokémon imagery sees the world from the same angles that the delivery robot will see it.

By recognising landmarks like buildings, signs, and street features, they can pinpoint their location with remarkable accuracy.

In simple terms, they navigate less like a satellite and more like a human. Rather than asking, “Where am I on a map?”, they ask, “What does this place look like, and have I seen it before?”

The implications are fascinating. That slightly chaotic, playful period when millions of people were glued to their phones, wandering through parks and city streets, has effectively trained machines to understand the physical world.

Not in a controlled lab, but in the messy, unpredictable reality of everyday life.

Most players weren’t thinking about contributing to a global mapping system

while chasing virtual creatures.

It raises important questions about how data is collected, who owns it, and how it might be used in the future.

But it also highlights something about technology’s evolution.

We rarely build the future in a straight line. More often, we stumble into it - through games, habits, and small everyday moments that seem insignificant at the time.

So, the next time a small robot rolls up with your pizza, navigating confidently along the footpath, it’s worth considering: its sense of direction may well have been shaped by families like ours, circling suburban streets in search of something that, at the time, felt like nothing more than a bit of fun.

I am feeling generous this year! Send a question or comment about this article to ask@techtalk.digital and the first ten e-mails will receive a FREE Tech Talk compilation book! Get curious, get involved, get a freebie!

WINS Community Centre a welcoming open space – open for everyone

A COMMUNITY barbecue and introduction of new board members and staff marked a fresh chapter for WINS Community Centre (Wellington Information & Neighbourhood Services) in Swift Street.

And as general manager Tina Newman said during the open day last Wednesday, that the centre is open with a clear focus on strengthening community ties and increasing engagement.

Reconnection with local residents is the aim for WINS Community Centre which has positively emerged from several months of uncertainty.

The day brought together families, young people, and community members for an afternoon of food, conversation, and exploration.

Guests were treated to a complimentary barbecue, along with snacks and refreshments, as they toured the centre and experienced its facilities firsthand.

The open-day atmosphere gave visitors the opportunity to meet the new team behind WINS and learn more about the programs available.

Ms Newman addressed attendees, reassuring the community that the centre remains a welcoming and active space.

“We are still open for business and open for everyone to come in,” Ms Newman said.

“WINS continues to offer a range of youth-focused programs designed to support and engage young people in the area.”

On Wednesday afternoons, the centre runs a Youth Centre program for children aged eight to 11, providing structured activities and opportunities for social connection after school.

For older youth, aged 12 to 17, a Youth Drop-In Centre operates on Thursday and Friday evenings, offering a safe and relaxed environment for teenagers to gather.

WINS also offer a range of different services such as SecondBite, Centrelink Services 9am-4:30pm, Live Better, APM, Real Futures and NSW Housing.

The newly appointed staff includes Tina Newman as Operations Manager, Ashleigh Ibrahim as Community/Youth Worker, Mason Hill as Youth Worker, and Tenika Dukeson at Reception.

They are supported by a newly formed board of directors: Steve Hodge, Connie Ah-See, Julian Carson, Ray Peckham, William Stanely, Elizabeth Shirlaw and Dianne McGlenn.

The team hopes the successful turnout is



All are welcome at WINS Community Centre in Swift Street. Many may remember the centre at the Wellington Information and Neighbourhood Centre established during the 1990s whose mission of helping all still stands.

just the beginning.

They encourage locals to visit the centre, get involved in programs, and make use of the space.

If you would like to be a part of the team

or like helping our community, WINS is looking for volunteers.

If interested, just come drop in and have a chat. All at WINS must have a current Working with Children Check.

Mid Macquarie Landcare has been busy already during this first quarter of 2026

The Nature Spotters groups in Dubbo and Yeoval have been dipping for waterbugs, paddling the Macquarie Waambul River, raving over reptiles, and macro-spotting with microscopes and more.

At the Bird Photography Workshop on Saturday, March 7 wildlife photographer and ecologist, David Cunningham was a great success among the 15 participants who gathered at the Stewart’s property, ‘Minalty Park’, Curra Creek on what turned out to be an ideally overcast morning.

Mr Cunningham shared practical advice on how to take photographs for maximum impact by considering natural light, composition and shutter speed settings.

He also discussed animal behaviour and, how as photographers, to minimise our intrusion on wildlife.

As participants meandered along the creek, he offered one-on-one advice to help each capture the best shots.

Participants spotted a wide variety of birds providing them ample opportunity to hone their photographic skills.

The sighting of a Diamond Firetail and a Rainbow bee-eater were amongst the morning’s highlights.

One participant, a keen birder, tallied 22 native bird species of the 45 ever recorded on the property.

The diversity of birds on local land is an indicator of overall biodiversity and a reminder of the critical role remnant habitat plays in supporting this.

Gratitude was extended to Mr Cunningham, who travelled from Canberra to present at the workshop and to David and Gail Stewart who kindly hosted at

Minalty Park.

This workshop was made possible by the funding from the BBBB Project, a partnership project with Little River Landcare group, supported by the EnergyCo Local Community Fund.

Citizen science for Raptors

Calling all local citizen scientists

Mid Macquarie Landcare needs your help to learn more about our local raptor species.

Simply download the iNaturalist app, create a profile, and join the Birds of Prey - Mid Macquarie Landcare project by searching in the projects list.

Indian Myna Traps

Mid Macquarie Landcare has Peegee Traps and an Aviary trap for members to hire.

Non- members can hire these or purchase Peegees for \$60 each.

Help us control the increase of this pest bird problem in our area.

Subsidised Soil Testing and Interpretation

During April/May Mid Macquarie Landcare is offering subsidised soil testing for local landholders.

This project will be run in partnership with Little River Landcare and is based on their popular SoilPEt project where



we’ll come to you and collect soil samples from one good and one problem area of your farm.

Then carry out comprehensive soil tests at 5cm increments to identify any production issues lurking below the surface (50% Subsidised. Total cost to you of \$250).

Provide expert support to interpret the soil test results, understand what they mean for you and how to address any challenges.

However, you must be a member of Mid Macquarie Landcare or Little River Landcare to participate and we will be prioritising soil testing for pasture management.

Call or email us to EOI and secure your place. At: info@mml.org.au



Styled by Sim



Simone McManus
Suite 1
36-42 Swift St
Wellington
02 6845 1976



WELLINGTON MEN’S SHED

Join us for friendship or fabrication or both

NEW MEMBERS WELCOME

SHED OPEN
Monday, Wednesday & Friday
from 8:30 – 12:00pm

Give us a call on 6845 2070



keirle’s  **alliance**
pharmacy PHARMACY

where local health matters

EXCITING NEWS

Giftware Back In Store Soon



31 Nanima Crescent, Wellington
02 6845 2059

email:keirles@alliancepharmacy.com.au * Check us out on facebook

Water Delivery

Domestic Water Deliveries
Servicing Wellington Region

Fiona: 0427 463 441 Ken: 0427 463 442

Tell our advertisers
you saw it in the
‘Leader’

Church Services

Anglican Parish of Wellington
WELLINGTON – St John the Baptist Church
Sunday 9am
Sunday 5pm - The Gathering
MARANATHA
11am on 2nd & 4th Friday of month.

Wellington Baptist Church
77 Swift Street
9:30am Sunday mornings
6pm Evening Service

Wellington Uniting Church
Sunday at 9.30am

St Patrick’s Catholic Parish
Saturday
6pm – Mass, St Patrick’s Church, Wellington
8.30am - Stuart Town
Sunday
8am – Our Lady’s Church, Yeoval first, third and fifth Sundays of the month
10am – Our Lady’s Church, Yeoval second and fourth Sundays of the month
10am – St Patrick’s Church, Wellington first, third and fifth Sundays of the month
8am – St Patrick’s Church, Wellington second and fourth Sundays of the month
Weekday mass
Please check parish bulletin
In Christ Chapel
2pm Sunday

Everyone looks at the classifieds.

Promote your
Annual General Meetings, Social Club Events,
Birthday Parties
Homes and Flats to rent or wanted to rent
Lost and Found
Garage Sale
Memorium
Public Notice
Raffle prize winners
\$22 for 2cm in 2 column display
We’ll fit any size Phone
0407 935 998

Scan & check out our new website



Wellington & District
LEADER

Tell our advertisers you saw it in the *‘Leader’*

Around the electorate with our State Member Dugald Saunders



Focus on fuel
WITH FUEL prices continuing to skyrocket, families across the state are starting to rethink their upcoming Easter holiday plans.
On Tuesday the NSW Nationals and Liberal called on the Minns Labor Government to help take the financial pressure off regional families, by providing free XPT and Trainlink coach services over the long weekend.
In Parliament, the NSW Nationals and Liberals also attempted to suspend ordinary proceedings to introduce legislation for Phase One of our Fuel Transparency Plan, which is designed to deliver greater price transparency, stronger compliance enforcement and long-term protection for motorists facing rising petrol prices.
Similar to the schemes already implemented in Victoria and Western Australia, the plan includes a price-lock feature, which requires fuel retailers to fix and publicly advertise their maximum price for 24 hours to prevent shock at the bowser, and the requirement for retailers to provide

advance notice of the next day’s fuel prices, so motorists can plan ahead.
Unfortunately, despite stating that they welcome all good ideas just moments before in Question Time, the Minns Labor Government ultimately shut down this debate.

Young leaders in Parliament
It was great to welcome Skye and Hayley (Narromine High School), Sophie and Jim (St Johns College Dubbo), Gabriella and Jayden (Dubbo College Senior Campus), and Aylah and Vincent (Wellington High School) when they visited Parliament last week as part of their participation in the Secondary Student Leadership Program.
This program recognises the leadership role of the invited students and provides them with the opportunity to develop their leadership skills, meet community leaders – including other student leaders, elected representatives, parliamentary officials and the Governor – and learn about constitutional and parliamentary processes.

Big Tech, big ideas
The ‘Big Tech, Big Ideas’ Agricultural Field Day will be held at the Dubbo Showground on Thursday 26 and Friday 27 March.
Showcasing the latest innovations from Agtech suppliers, agricultural machinery companies, startups, researchers and government agencies, this event is an opportunity to check out the latest farm technology solutions up close, with live demonstrations, hands-on activities, and speaker sessions from industry leaders.
Tickets and the event program are available at:
<https://www.agtech.dpi.nsw.gov.au/pages/big-tech-big-ideas>

Supporting STEM students
Calling all Principals and STEM teachers! The STEM Equity & Access Program 2026 is now open to applications for Round 2.
Principals and STEM teachers can apply for funding to support individual high school students or a group looking to

participate in a STEM competition, event or course in the second half of 2026.
Applications close 10.00am, Monday, April 6.
For more, visit:
<https://www.nsw.gov.au/grants-and-funding/stem-equity-access-program-2026-round-2>

Event fund opens
Event organisers in the Dubbo electorate are invited to apply for assistance through the Regional Event Fund 2026/27.
Grants are available through three funding streams to support organisers in delivering events that attract visitors, driving overnight stays and boosting local economies.
Applications for the Incubator Event and Flagship Event streams close Sunday, April 12.
For more, visit: <https://www.destinationnsw.com.au/destination-nsw-business-support/grants-and-funding>

Until next time,
Dugald

Andrew GEE MP

INDEPENDENT FEDERAL MEMBER FOR CALARE

Your True Country
Independent



RUNS ON THE BOARD FOR WELLINGTON

- ✓ \$9.5 million for Mananatha House Aged Care
- ✓ Introduced Bill into Parliament to ban foreign buying of residential property for two years. The Coalition and the Labor Party voted against it and then they both announced it as their policy!
- ✓ Backed Independents' Bill to reduce dominance of big supermarkets. All major parties voted against it and then Coalition announced it as their policy!
- ✓ \$50 million for storm and flood recovery in the Central West
- ✓ Secured the Parliamentary Inquiry into the Disaster
- ✓ Response of Insurers \$2 billion for Great Western Highway upgrade
- ✓ \$2.02 million for replacing the Terrabella, Burrendong and Gundy Creek Bridges
- ✓ \$738,000 for the Cameron Park footbridge
- ✓ 60 mobile phone towers and base stations for Calare
- ✓ \$560,000 for Stuart Town water security project
- ✓ Secured upgrade of Wellington Hospital Emergency Department
- ✓ \$1.5 million for the intergenerational childcare facility at
- ✓ Wellington's Mananatha House
- ✓ \$1.1 million for Ponto Falls Road upgrade
- ✓ \$26,700 for the Driver Reviver site at the Wellington Information Centre
- ✓ \$1.176 million for improvements at Wellington Caves
- ✓ \$1.2 million for security CCTV in Wellington and Calare communities
- ✓ \$650,000 for upgrades at Wellington Christian School
- ✓ \$200,000 for improvements at Kennard Park
- ✓ \$46,454 for Geurie Racecourse and Recreation Reserve Revitalisation Project Stage Two
- ✓ \$50,000 for Wellington Library's outdoor reading room
- ✓ Video link for Wellington Court House

ENOUGH IS ENOUGH!

Earlier this week in Parliament I told the government: the people of the Central West are **DONE** with being treated like second-class citizens!

Our region is under an **economic siege**. With empty diesel tanks at sowing time and the catastrophic closure of the Great Western Highway at Victoria Pass, our farmers, small businesses and local families are being pushed to the brink. Let's be clear: If our farmers cannot plant, this nation does not eat.

We are **DONE** with band-aid solutions, "resilience" talks, and forever roadworks.

I called for:

- **Immediate action** to secure our fuel supply for country Australia.
- **Immediate support packages** for businesses smashed by the highway closure.

The Central West is the food bowl of this nation. Our contribution to the prosperity of Australia makes us a powerhouse. Yet infuriatingly, this is not reflected in the way we are being treated.



FIGHTING FOR MEALS ON WHEELS

In Parliament recently I met with the Minister for Aged Care, Sam Rae MP, so he could hear firsthand from Leanne Wright, the Manager of Blayney Meals on Wheels, exactly what proposed federal government changes mean for our local seniors.

The reality is shocking: if our local services are forced to transition into the Support at Home model, a nutritious three-course meal could skyrocket, costing from around \$12 up to nearly \$70.

Leanne didn't mince words with the Minister. She told him directly: "People will die".

If our seniors can't afford to eat, they will disconnect from the service, end up in hospital, or worse.

Minister Rae listened to our concerns, and now we need him to act.

Meals on Wheels is such a vital service and it simply must not be folded into a model that doesn't work for our communities.

We're determined to support and keep our vital local services!



KEEPING UP THE FIGHT TO PROTECT OUR PRIME AGRICULTURAL LAND

This week in Parliament I presented my Protecting Australia's Prime Agricultural Land Bill 2026, which I first brought before the House of Representatives last year. This landmark legislation is aimed at securing the future of our most valuable farming land and, with it, our national food security. Despite agriculture being central to Australia's prosperity, we have never enacted laws to properly safeguard the land that sustains it.

The urgency is clear. Agricultural production has grown significantly in recent decades, with exports making up a substantial share of our economy and supporting regional communities. As global populations rise, the importance of food and water security continues to increase, making the protection of prime agricultural land a national priority.

My bill establishes a simple principle: prime agricultural land must be preserved for agriculture. It prohibits non-agricultural use, ensures new owners maintain that purpose, prevents the expansion of existing non-agricultural activities, and requires land to return to farming if other uses cease. These measures are designed to stop the gradual loss of critical farmland.

Governments at all levels have failed to act. Poor planning decisions and a lack of strong legislation have allowed valuable farmland to be steadily eroded. This bill is a necessary step to correct that neglect.

Food security is national security. A country that cannot feed itself is vulnerable. Australia's farmers are among the best in the world, but the land they depend on is finite. We cannot continue to build over it.

My bill calls on all sides of Parliament to protect agriculture and secure Australia's future.

Sadly, when I have put this game changing legislation to a vote, none of the major parties have backed it in and supported it.

ORANGE ELECTORATE OFFICE

📍 1/179a Anson Street
✉ PO Box 673
Orange NSW 2800

☎ (02) 6361 7138
@ andrew.gee.mp@aph.gov.au
🌐 www.andrewgeemp.com.au

For regular updates and news,
follow me on Facebook and
Instagram @andrewgeecalare



Authorised by Andrew Gee MP, Suite 1/179a Anson Street Orange NSW 2800

6.00 Morning Programs. **11.00** Creative Types With Virginia Trioli. **11.30** Can You Keep A Secret? **12.00** ABC News At Noon. **1.00** Frauds. **2.00** Parliament Question Time. **3.00** Fake Or Fortune? **4.00** Sister Boniface Mysteries. **4.45** Long Lost Family. **5.30** Antiques Roadshow. **6.30** Hard Quiz. **7.00** ABC News. **7.30** 7.30. **8.00** Back Roads. **8.30** Creative Types With Virginia Trioli. **9.00** The Piano. **9.50** The Matter Of Facts. **10.40** ABC Late News. **10.55** The Business. **11.10** Sister Boniface Mysteries. **11.55** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **2.00** South Aussie With Cost. **2.30** Air Crash Investigations. **3.30** Harry's Practice. **4.00** Medical Emergency. **4.30** Better Homes And Gardens. **5.30** Escape To The Country. **6.30** Bargain Hunt. **7.30** Father Brown. **8.30** The Inspector Lynley Mysteries. **10.30** Murdoch Mysteries. **11.30** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **2.15** ER. **3.00** QI. **3.30** Would I Lie To You? **4.00** MythBusters. **4.55** Phil Spencer: Secret Agent. **5.40** Portrait Artist Of The Year. **6.30** House Of Games. **7.00** Spicks And Specks. **7.30** QI. **8.00** Would I Lie To You? **8.30** Tonight At The Museum. **9.00** Given. **9.40** Late Programs.

6.00 Sunrise. **9.00** The Morning Show. **12.00** Seven's National News At Noon. **1.10** Catch Phrase. **2.00** Bridge Of Lies: Celebrity Specials. **3.00** The Chase. **4.00** Seven News At 4. **5.00** The Chase Australia. **6.00** 7News Local. **6.30** 7News @ 6.30. **7.00** Home And Away. **7.30** Highway Patrol. **8.00** Motorway Patrol. **8.30** MOVIE: Bridget Jones's Baby. (2016) Renée Zellweger, Colin Firth, Patrick Dempsey. **11.30** To Be Advised. **12.20** Damnation. **1.20** Travel Oz. **2.00** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **2.30** The Force: Behind The Line. **3.30** Swamp People: Serpent Invasion. **4.30** American Restoration. **5.00** Storage Wars. **5.30** American Pickers. **6.30** Pawn Stars. **7.00** Football. AFL. Round 3. Geelong v Adelaide. **10.30** AFL Post-Game Show. **11.00** Kick Ons. **11.30** Late Programs.

6.00 Kids' Programs. **2.45** The Makers. **3.00** Play School. **3.40** Thomas And Friends. **4.15** Andy's Safari Adventures. **5.20** Millie Magnificent. **6.05** PJ Masks. **7.05** Batwheels. **7.35** Ninjago. **8.00** Deadly 60. **8.35** Secrets Of The Zoo. **9.20** Ultimate Vets. **9.40** Animal Park. **11.10** Late Programs.

6.00 Today. **9.00** Today Extra. **11.30** 9News Morning. **12.00** Married At First Sight. **1.30** My Way. **2.00** Pointless. **3.00** Tipping Point. **4.00** 9News Afternoon. **4.30** Tipping Point Australia. **5.30** WIN News. **6.00** 9News. **7.00** A Current Affair. **7.30** Rugby League. NRL. Round 4. Manly Sea Eagles v Sydney Roosters. **9.55** NRL Thursday Night Footy Post-Match. **10.40** 9News Late. **11.10** The Equalizer. **12.05** Tipping Point. **1.00** Great Australian Detour. **1.30** TV Shop: Home Shopping. **2.00** Late Programs.

6.00 It's Academic. **7.30** Get Clever. **8.30** Flushed. **9.00** Home Shopping. **10.00** Jabba's Movies School Holiday Special. **10.30** Farmer Wants A Wife. **12.00** Code Black. **3.00** Frogger. **4.00** Lopez Vs. Lopez. **4.30** The Conners. **5.30** Bondi Vet. **6.30** Judge Judy. **7.30** Ramsay's Kitchen Nightmares USA. **10.30** First Dates UK. **11.30** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **2.00** Parliament. **3.10** ABC News Afternoons. **4.00** Afternoon Briefing. **5.00** ABC News With Joe O'Brien. **6.00** ABC News Hour. **7.00** ABC National News. **7.30** 7.30. **8.00** ABC News Tonight. **8.45** The Business. **9.00** The World. **10.00** ABC Nightly News. **10.30** Foreign Correspondent. **11.00** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **9.00** The Finish Line. **10.00** Ent. Tonight. **10.30** Kate: A Queen For The Future. **11.30** My Market Kitchen. **12.00** GCBC. **12.30** Family Feud. **1.00** News. **2.00** Millionaire Hot Seat. **2.30** The Finish Line. **3.30** Lingo. **4.30** The Bold And The Beautiful. **5.00** 10 News. **6.00** 10 News+. **6.30** Deal Or No Deal. **7.00** Millionaire Hot Seat. **7.30** Gogglebox Australia. **8.30** The Graham Norton Show. **9.40** 10's Late News. **10.40** 10 News+. **11.10** The Late Show With Stephen Colbert. **12.00** Late Programs.

6.00 Home Shopping. **8.00** Days Of Our Lives. **8.45** The Young And The Restless. **9.30** JAG. **10.30** The Living Room. **11.30** The Bold And The Beautiful. **12.00** Days Of Our Lives. **12.45** The Young And The Restless. **1.30** JAG. **3.30** Bull. **4.30** JAG. **6.30** Bull. **7.30** NCIS. **10.20** Bull. **12.15** Home Shopping.

6.00 Morning Programs. **1.00** Midsomer Murders. **3.00** Antiques Roadshow. **3.30** MOVIE: Carry On Screaming! (1966) **5.30** Yorkshire Auction House. **6.30** Antiques Roadshow. **7.30** RBT. **8.30** Emergency. **9.30** A+E Crash Scene Emergency. **10.30** Forensics: The Real CSI. **11.45** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **12.00** WorldWatch. **2.05** 1945: The Year That Changed History. **3.05** Going Places With Ernie Dingo. **3.40** The Cook Up With Adam Liaw. **4.15** Secrets Of The Tower Of London. **5.05** Jeopardy! **5.30** Letters And Numbers. **6.00** Mastermind Australia. **6.30** SBS World News. **7.35** Treasures With Bettany Hughes. **8.30** Our Medicine. **9.40** A Spy Among Friends. Final. **10.45** SBS World News Late. **11.15** In Memoriam. **12.10** Blackwater. **2.25** Silent Road. **3.20** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **10.30** Deal Or No Deal. **11.00** Millionaire Hot Seat. **11.30** Becker. **12.00** Frasier. **1.00** The Big Bang Theory. **2.00** Friends. **3.30** Becker. **4.00** Good Chef Bad Chef. **4.30** Frasier. **5.30** The Big Bang Theory. **6.30** Friends. **8.00** The Big Bang Theory. **10.00** Becker. **10.30** Frasier. **11.30** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **2.05** Insight. **3.10** WorldWatch. **5.10** Alone Denmark. **6.20** The Curse Of Oak Island. **7.10** Jeopardy! **7.40** 8 Out Of 10 Cats Does Countdown. **8.30** United Gangs Of America. **10.20** The UnXplained With William Shatner. **11.10** Brassic. **12.55** The Swiping Game. **1.20** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **12.00** ABC News At Noon. **1.00** The Piano. **1.45** Can You Keep A Secret? **2.15** The Assembly. **3.00** Fake Or Fortune? **4.00** Murdoch Mysteries. **4.45** Long Lost Family. **5.30** Antiques Roadshow. **6.30** Hard Quiz. **7.00** ABC News. **7.30** Gardening Australia. **8.30** Patience. Return. **9.20** Tonight At The Museum. **9.50** The Weekly With Charlie Pickering. **10.20** Shaun Micallef's Eve Of Destruction. **10.55** ABC Late News. **11.15** Melbourne Comedy Festival Gala. **1.15** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **2.00** Our Town. **2.30** Sydney Weekender. **3.00** Kochie's Business Builders. **3.30** Harry's Practice. **4.00** Better Homes And Gardens. **5.00** Escape To The Country. **6.00** Bargain Hunt. **7.00** Better Homes And Gardens. **8.00** Escape To The Country. **11.00** The Yorkshire Vet. **12.00** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **2.10** ER. **3.05** QI. **3.35** Would I Lie To You? **4.05** MythBusters. **5.00** Phil Spencer: Secret Agent. **5.45** Portrait Artist Of The Year. **6.35** Richard Osman's House Of Games Night. **7.00** Spicks And Specks. **7.30** QI. **8.00** Would I Lie To You? **8.30** MOVIE: Disclosure. (1994) **10.35** Late Programs.

6.00 Sunrise. **9.00** The Morning Show. **12.00** Seven's National News At Noon. **1.00** MOVIE: Secret Diary Of A Cheerleader. (2023) Laurie Fortier. **3.00** The Chase. **4.00** Seven News At 4. **5.00** The Chase Australia. **6.00** 7News Local. **6.30** 7News @ 6.30. **7.00** Better Homes And Gardens. **7.30** Football. AFL. Round 3. Collingwood v GWS Giants. **10.30** AFL Post-Game Show. **11.15** GetOn Extra. **11.45** To Be Advised. **12.55** Damnation. **2.00** Home Shopping. **4.00** Million Dollar Minute. **5.00** NBC Today.

6.00 Morning Programs. **3.00** Timbersports. **3.30** Swamp People: Serpent Invasion. **4.30** American Resto. **5.00** Storage Wars. **5.30** American Pickers. **6.30** Pawn Stars. **7.00** AFL: Friday Night Countdown. **7.30** Surveillance Oz. **8.30** MOVIE: Whitney Houston: I Wanna Dance With Somebody. (2022) **11.35** Late Programs.

6.00 Kids' Programs. **3.40** Thomas And Friends. **4.15** Andy's Safari Adventures. **5.20** Millie Magnificent. **6.05** PJ Masks. **7.05** Gardening Australia Junior. **7.35** Star Wars: Young Jedi Adventures. **8.00** Scooby-Doo And Guess Who? **8.30** My Adventures With Superman. **8.50** BattleBots. **9.40** Gladiators UK. **10.40** Late Programs.

6.00 Today. **9.00** Today Extra. **11.30** 9News Morning. **12.00** MOVIE: The Love Hunt. (2023) **2.00** Pointless. **3.00** Tipping Point. **4.00** 9News Afternoon. **4.30** Tipping Point Australia. **5.30** WIN News. **6.00** 9News. **7.00** A Current Affair. **7.30** Rugby League. NRL. Round 4. Brisbane Broncos v Dolphins. **9.55** NRL Friday Night Footy Post-Match. **10.45** MOVIE: Gringo. (2018) David Oyelowo. **1.00** Next Stop. **1.30** TV Shop: Home Shopping. **4.00** Skippy The Bush Kangaroo. **4.30** Global Shop. **5.00** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **12.00** Code Black. **3.00** Animals Aboard With Dr Harry. **3.50** Australian Idol. **5.00** Australia's Got Talent. **6.25** MOVIE: The Super Mario Bros. Movie. (2023) **8.30** MOVIE: Once Upon A Time... In Hollywood. (2019) Leonardo DiCaprio, Brad Pitt, Margot Robbie. **11.55** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **3.00** News. **4.00** Afternoon Briefing. **5.00** ABC News With Joe O'Brien. **6.00** ABC News Hour. **7.00** ABC National News. **7.30** The Pacific. **8.00** ABC News Tonight. **8.35** If You're Listening. **9.00** The World. **9.30** Expanse: The Nannup Four. **10.00** ABC Nightly News. **10.30** Late Programs.

6.00 Ent. Tonight. **6.30** Bold. **7.00** Deal Or No Deal. **7.30** GCBC. **8.00** Lingo. **9.00** The Finish Line. **10.00** Ent. Tonight. **10.30** Jamie Oliver: Eat Yourself Healthy. **11.30** My Market Kitchen. **12.00** GCBC. **12.30** Family Feud. **1.00** News. **2.00** Millionaire Hot Seat. **2.30** The Finish Line. **3.30** Lingo. **4.30** The Bold And The Beautiful. **5.00** 10 News. **6.00** 10 News+. **6.30** Deal Or No Deal. **7.00** Millionaire Hot Seat. **7.30** Soccer. FIFA Series. Australia v Cameroon. **10.30** 10's Late News. **11.30** 10 News+. **12.00** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **10.30** The Living Room. **11.30** The Bold And The Beautiful. **12.00** Days Of Our Lives. **12.45** The Young And The Restless. **1.30** JAG. **3.30** Bull. **4.30** JAG. **6.30** Bull. **7.30** Basketball. NBL. Grand Finals Series. Adelaide 36ers v Sydney Kings. Game 2. **9.30** NCIS. **12.20** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **1.00** The Brokerwood Mysteries. **3.00** Explore TV. **3.30** Yorkshire Auction House. **4.30** Rugby Union. Women's International. Australia v Fiji. **7.00** Customs. **7.30** Airport Security. USA. **8.30** MOVIE: The Blind Side. (2009) Sandra Bullock, Tim McGraw. **11.10** MOVIE: Fall. (2022) **1.10** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **12.00** WorldWatch. **2.05** Windsor Castle Fire: The Untold Story. **3.00** NITV News. Nula. **3.40** The Cook Up With Adam Liaw. **4.15** Secrets Of The Tower Of London. **5.05** Jeopardy! **5.30** Letters And Numbers. **6.00** Mastermind Australia. **6.30** SBS World News. **7.30** Going Places With Ernie Dingo. **8.30** Titanic In Colour. **10.20** SBS World News Late. **10.50** Sisi. **11.50** Babylon Berlin. **1.40** El Immortal: Gangs Of Madrid. **3.30** Food, Sail, Love. **4.05** Bamay. **5.00** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **10.30** Deal Or No Deal. **11.00** Millionaire Hot Seat. **11.30** Becker. **12.00** Frasier. **1.00** The Big Bang Theory. **2.00** Friends. **3.30** Becker. **4.00** Good Chef Bad Chef. **4.30** Frasier. **5.30** The Big Bang Theory. **6.30** Friends. **8.00** The Big Bang Theory. **10.00** Becker. **10.30** Frasier. **11.30** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **2.30** Bamay. **3.05** Where Are You Really From? **3.40** WorldWatch. **5.40** Inside The Huddle. **6.30** Over The Black Dot. **6.40** The Future With Hannah Fry. **7.10** Jeopardy! **7.40** 8 Out Of 10 Cats Does Countdown. **8.30** MOVIE: Stolen. (2012) **10.15** Adam Hills: The Last Leg. **11.05** Homeland. **12.00** Late Programs.

6.00 Rage Charts. **7.00** Weekend Breakfast. **9.00** Rage. **10.30** Rage Vault. Guest Programmer. **12.00** ABC News At Noon. **12.30** Blue Murder Motel. **1.15** Patience. **2.10** David Attenborough's First Life. Final. **3.10** Extraordinary Escapes. Final. **4.10** The Matter Of Facts. **5.00** Australian Story. **5.30** Landline. **6.00** Kath & Kim. **6.30** Hard Quiz. **7.00** ABC News. **7.30** Blue Murder Motel. **8.15** Top End Bub. **8.40** Death In Paradise. **9.40** Frauds. **10.30** Rage.

6.00 Morning Programs. **2.30** Medical Emergency. **3.00** Better Homes And Gardens. **4.00** The Yorkshire Vet. **5.00** Horse Racing. Family Stakes Day And Aust Cup Day. **6.00** Luxury Escapes: World's Best Holidays. **6.30** Dog Patrol. **7.00** Better Homes And Gardens. **8.00** Lewis. **10.00** Escape To The Country. **11.00** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **3.00** Nigella's Cook, Eat, Repeat. **3.30** QI. **4.00** Would I Lie To You? **4.35** MythBusters. **5.25** Phil Spencer: Secret Agent. **6.15** Portrait Artist Of The Year. **7.00** Spicks And Specks. **7.30** QI. **8.00** Would I Lie To You? **8.30** Melbourne Comedy Festival Gala. **10.30** Late Programs.

6.00 NBC Today. **7.00** Weekend Sunrise. **10.00** The Morning Show: Weekend. **12.00** Horse Racing. Family Stakes Day And Australian Cup Day. **5.00** Seven News At 5. **5.30** Border Security: Australia's Front Line. **6.00** Seven News. **7.00** Border Security: Australia's Front Line. **7.30** Athletics. Maurie Plant Meet. **9.30** MOVIE: Men In Black: International. (2019) Chris Hemsworth, Tessa Thompson, Liam Neeson. **11.45** To Be Advised. **1.00** Devils. **2.00** Home Shopping. **4.00** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **2.00** Rides Down Under: Aussie Truckers. **3.00** Motor Racing. Night Thunder. Aust Nationals. H'lights. **4.00** Frozen Gold. **5.00** Counting Cars. **6.00** Pawn Stars. **7.00** Storage Wars. **7.30** MOVIE: The Mummy: Tomb Of The Dragon Emperor. (2008) **9.45** MOVIE: Backdraft. (1991) **12.30** Late Programs.

6.00 Kids' Programs. **3.45** The Gruffalo. **4.30** Little J And Big Cuz. **5.10** The Snail And The Whale. **6.05** Knee High Spies. **6.25** The Adventures Of Paddington. **7.05** Let's Go Bananas! **7.30** Kids Baking Championship. **8.10** Harry Potter: Wizards Of Baking. **8.55** Chopped Junior. **10.00** Fresh Off The Boat. **10.40** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **12.00** Open For Inspection. **12.30** Drive TV: What Drives Us. **1.00** My Way. **1.30** Great Australian Detour. **2.00** Global Energy Revolution. **3.00** Explore TV. **3.30** Epic Builds. **4.30** The Garden Gurus. **5.00** 9News First At Five. **5.30** Getaway. **6.00** 9News Saturday. **7.00** A Current Affair. **7.30** Space Invaders. **8.30** MOVIE: Meg 2: The Trench. (2023) Jason Statham, Jing Wu, Shuya Sophia Cai. **10.50** MOVIE: Into The Blue 2: The Reef. (2009) **12.35** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **12.00** The Food Dude. **1.00** Instant Hotel. **2.20** Dancing With The Stars. **4.30** Australian Idol. **5.40** MOVIE: Cloudy With A Chance Of Meatballs. (2009) **7.30** MOVIE: Sister Act. (1992) Whoopi Goldberg. **9.40** MOVIE: The Bone Collector. (1999) Denzel Washington. **12.10** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **3.30** That Pacific Sports Show. **4.00** News. **4.30** Expanse: The Nannup Four. **5.00** News. **5.30** Asia News Week. **6.00** Evening News. **6.30** Aust Story. **7.00** National News. **7.30** Back Roads. **8.00** News Tonight. **8.15** Four Corners. **9.00** Nightly News. **9.30** Foreign Correspondent. **10.00** Late Programs.

6.00 Tough Tested. **7.00** Reel Action. **7.30** Escape Fishing. **8.00** I Fish. **8.30** On The Fly. **9.00** All 4 Adventure. **10.00** 4x4 Adventures. **11.00** Dogs Behaving (Very) Badly Australia. **12.00** Australian Survivor: Redemption. **1.30** What's Up Down Under. **2.00** Farm To Fork. **2.30** Next Gen Dairy. Return. **3.00** Millionaire Hot Seat. **3.30** Lingo. **4.30** Ultimate Classroom. **5.00** 10 News. **6.30** The Dog House. **7.30** Love It Or List It Australia. **9.30** Gogglebox Australia. **10.30** Elsbeth. **11.30** Late Programs.

6.00 Home Shopping. **9.00** Reel Action. **9.30** All 4 Adventure. **10.30** Navigating The World. **11.30** JAG. **2.30** Soccer. A-League Women. Round 21. Adelaide United v Newcastle Jets. **4.40** Soccer. A-League Women. Round 21. Sydney FC v Melbourne Victory. **7.00** JAG. **8.00** NCIS. **10.45** JAG. **12.45** Home Shopping.

6.00 Morning Programs. **12.30** The Avengers. **1.30** MOVIE: The Gentle Gunman. (1952) **3.20** MOVIE: The Heart Of The Matter. (1953) **5.30** MOVIE: Saturday Island. (1952) **7.30** Death In Paradise. **8.40** MOVIE: Cheaper By The Dozen. (2003) Steve Martin, Bonnie Hunt. **10.40** MOVIE: Dirty Rotten Scoundrels. (1988) **12.55** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **12.00** WorldWatch. **2.00** Cycling. UCI World Tour. Milan-San Remo. Men's Race. H'lights. **3.00** Stories From The Cities. **3.30** Going Places With Ernie Dingo. **4.30** Gestapo: Hitler's Secret Police. **5.35** Orphans Of WW2. **6.30** SBS World News. **7.30** Jewels Of The Mediterranean. **8.25** Homebodies. **9.25** MOVIE: The Hostages' Story. (2025) Nazanin Zaghari Ratcliffe. **11.05** Snowpiercer. **1.45** El Immortal: Gangs Of Madrid. **3.30** Food, Sail, Love. **4.05** Bamay. **5.15** Late Programs.

6.00 Good Chef Bad Chef. **7.00** The Bold And The Beautiful. **9.30** Millionaire Hot Seat. **10.00** Ultimate Classroom. **10.30** Millionaire Hot Seat. **11.00** Good Chef Bad Chef. **11.30** Ridiculousness. **2.00** Friends. **6.00** The Big Bang Theory. **10.30** Ridiculousness. **12.00** Home Shopping.

6.00 Morning Programs. **2.00** WorldWatch. **4.00** The Story Of. **4.35** The Future. **5.05** Mastermind Aust. **6.30** The Food That Built The World. **7.00** Motorcycle Racing. Australian Superbike Championship. Round 2. **10.00** Abandoned Americana. **10.55** Marcella. **12.45** Bamay. **1.20** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **10.00** Offsiders. **10.30** The World This Week. **11.00** Compass. **11.30** Songs Of Praise. **12.00** ABC News At Noon. **12.30** Landline. **1.30** Gardening Australia. **2.30** The Piano. **3.30** Inside The Sydney Opera House. **4.30** Creative Types With Virginia Trioli. **5.00** Back Roads. **5.30** Fake Or Fortune? Return. **6.30** Compass. **7.00** ABC News. **7.30** The Piano. **8.00** Can You Keep A Secret? **8.50** Frauds. **9.35** Blue Murder Motel. **10.25** Top End Bub. **10.45** MOVIE: Sweetie. (1989) **12.25** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **1.30** Kochie's Business Builders. **2.00** South Aussie With Cost. **2.30** Medical Emergency. **3.15** The Yorkshire Vet. **4.15** Australia's Big Backyards. **5.15** The Aussie Property Flippers. **6.15** Escape To The Country. **7.15** The Vicar Of Dibley. **8.30** Vera. **10.30** Miss Scarlet And The Duke. **11.30** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **2.15** ER. **3.05** A Bite To Eat. **3.35** QI. **4.05** Would I Lie To You? **4.35** MythBusters. **5.25** Phil Spencer: Secret Agent. **6.15** Portrait Artist Of The Year. **7.00** Spicks And Specks. **7.30** QI. **8.00** Would I Lie To You? **8.30** Louis Theroux: Under The Knife. **9.30** The Piano. **10.20** Late Programs.

6.00 NBC Today. **7.00** Weekend Sunrise. **10.00** The Morning Show: Weekend. **12.00** Sunday Footy Feast. **2.30** To Be Advised. **4.00** Better Homes And Gardens. **5.00** Seven News At 5. **5.30** Sydney Weekender. **6.00** Seven News. **7.00** Australian Idol. **8.45** Britain's Got Talent. **10.00** King Con: Life And Crimes Of Hamish McLaren. **12.00** A Friend Of The Family. **1.10** Travel Oz. **2.00** Home Shopping. **3.30** Million Dollar Minute. **4.00** NBC Today. **5.00** Sunrise Early News. **5.30** Sunrise.

6.00 Morning Programs. **2.00** Red's Fishing Adventures. **2.30</**



Wellington & District LEADER



2026 Wellington Boot Showcase



Wellington Soldiers Club Wellington Boot Carnival





President’s Message...



Wellington Race Club President, Peter Barton.

THE 46th Wellington Boot is fast approaching.
Wellington Race Club is very proud to present the race track and surrounds in pristine condition for another memorable fixture.
I cannot remember it looking better.
Due to the addition of Brett Thompson to our training ranks, joining long time Wellington horse trainer Jim McMillan, there should be numerous locally trained and owned horses running over the Boot carnival.

Another interest to locals shall be the apprentice jockey Jacob Stiff who honed his riding skills at Wellington Pony Club as a young boy.
Jake is now apprenticed to Michael Mulholland at Dubbo and has had a very successful start to his riding career already winning three Country Cups.
The WRC committee is very proud to present our two-day racing carnival on Friday and Sunday April 10 and 12, the main day Sunday is the richest race day (barring Scone Cup Day) in Country NSW.
Wellington is a relatively small race club but we certainly punch way

above our weight!
As President, I hope as many locals as possible can come along to help support one of Wellington’s major events and have a fun weekend.
I would like to thank all of our sponsors and all of the WRC committee for their assistance during the year, especially Sim and Mick Keirle and Jared Wykes without their tireless efforts WRC would not function.
See you all on Friday 10th and Sunday 12th of April for the ‘Richest Race in the West’.
Peter Barton
President WRC

Keen club members put in mammoth efforts

FORMERLY MEMBERS of the friendly team at Keirle’s Pharmacy in Wellington, Michael and Simone Keirle are now devoting much of their time to Wellington Race Club.
Simone is vice-president and Michael is treasurer of the club however the popular couple help out in many other ways for the benefit of racing in Wellington.
“I was basically just another “mug punter” until approached by the then president of the race club Ian Darney who invited me and Simone to become part of a group organised by Ian to race some horses and also to join the Wellington Race Club committee,” Michael Keirle revealed.
Trained for them by Stephen Jones at Scone, some of the gallopers had very successful careers including Akasaki (11 wins including in the city and over \$480,000 prizemoney), Hit The Target (nine wins including the Bathurst Soldiers Saddle and over \$250,000 prizemoney) and Toro Toro (eight wins and over \$225,000 prizemoney).
Although there is a lot of very hard work for the committee involved with organising race meetings and the general upkeep of the racecourse, Michael and Simone admit there is satisfaction in seeing improvements to facilities for trainers and racegoers and also helping organise a great community event, the famous



The grandstand kitchen has been revitalised allowing plenty of room for staff to provide quality customer service.

Wellington Boot carnival.
“Local builder Matt Redfern has done a great job in completing renovations including a new bar and kitchen in the fully air-conditioned area underneath the grandstand with this becoming possible following a grant from the NSW government to the Wellington Show”, explained Simone Keirle.
According to Simone there is “a real buzz” around the racecourse as an increased number of horses are having track gallops at Wellington.
“The track is in great condition, inquiries are flooding in from owners and trainers and accommodation is being rapidly booked out in town and surrounding areas so all is shaping up for a fantastic Wellington Boot Carnival”, they said.



Sam Redfern of Redfern Constructions putting finishing touches to the revamped bar.

Wellington Boot winners honour board

1981 Johnny Zero	2004 Flying Firebird
1982 Lucky Nap	2005 Thunder Hill
1983 Mystic Mahal	2006 He’s No Pie Eater
1984 Foystaan	2007 Richaz
1985 Matildas Waltz	2008 Sin Sin Sin
1986 Misty Crony	2009 Sutton Princess
1987 Dream Faith	2010 Derippa
1988 Entitled	2011 Jackpot Queen
1989 Swinging Minstrel	2012 Gold Bender
1990 Pushkin	2013 Power Alert
1991 Oak Street	2014 I Am Snippety
1992 Danza Dark	2015 Alart
1993 Acapulco Queen	2016 Alliterate
1994 Life Begins	2017 Lucy Rose
1995 Iron Horse	2018 Miss Invincible
1996 Brave Bulldog	2019 Superium
1997 Sengiggi Beach	2020 Zeftabrook
1998 Regulations	2021 Sonnet Star
1999 Parting Jester	2022 no race
2000 Arakoola	Meeting washed out
2001 City Fella	2023 Everlong
2002 Delusional	2024 Fingers Hunter
2003 Prince Nimrod	2025 Comongin



Comongin wins the 2025 \$200,000 Wellington Boot.



T&N AUTO & AG SERVICE

For all your MECHANICAL needs



92 Lee St, Wellington
Workshop:
(02) 6845 1112





Guys and Dolls Challenge - something old is new again

ADDING TO the glamour of Wellington Boot races in the early years of the carnival from 1981, was the Miss, then Ms Wellington Boot competition.

Times changed and the concept was put on the back-burner for some years.

However, organisers have revamped the idea and invite people 18 to 30 years to take up the new challenge.

Join the fun and become a challenger in the Guys and Dolls Challenge during the 2026 Wellington Boot Racing Carnival weekend.

All you have to do is fill-in an entry form at Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club – then turn up!

Attend the Boot Calcutta night at the Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club from 6pm in the auditorium Saturday, April 11, and if your name is drawn, you can draw a horse in the Wellington Boot race on Sunday 12th, gain free entry to the racecourse, enjoy a free lavish lunch and drinks throughout the day in the Wellington Race Club sponsors tent - all courtesy of Tooheys, Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club, *Wellington & District Leader*, Eliza Whiteley Optometry and Wellington Race Club.

The 2026 Wellington Boot Racing Carnival runs with an eight-race program on Friday, April 10 with \$10 admission on Friday.

The Boot Classic Golf Day at Wellington Golf Club runs on Saturday, then the Boot Calcutta on Saturday night with

guest host Miracle Mal Johnson, the legend of racing and Greg Ryan, a former Wellington local and deemed a gentleman of the turf.

With them will be NRL legend Gary Freeman.

Sunday is Boot day, the richest race over the great divide (bar Scone).

Gates open 11am and \$20 admission Sunday for everyone else without tickets.

Guys and Dolls Challenge

Fill-in an entry form at Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club or club website. You must be aged 18 to 30 years.

Attend the Wellington Boot Calcutta on Saturday night April 10.

If selected in the draw you gain free entry to Sunday's Boot race meeting as a guest in the Wellington Race Club sponsor's tent tent.

Each Challenger will receive a 2026 Wellington Boot Guys and Dolls sash to keep and wear forever.

How it works

There are 14 runners in the 2026 Wellington Boot race.

On Saturday night at Calcutta, entry forms will be drawn from a barrel and the person nominated must be at the Calcutta.

That person then draws a horse in the Boot race.

UP to 14 people will be drawn. If there are horse scratchings, then only Guys



There's some excellent prizes to be won in the 2026 Tooheys Guys and Dolls Challenge. Jacob Langsworthy and Molly Griggs wearing the special sashes for each challenger while they show the three prize baskets

and Dolls with remaining horses are eligible to win the First, Second or Third prizes available, which will be presented to the drawers of those placed horses after the race in the Saddling Ring. Dress-up for the day, and you may like to also enter 'Fashions on the Field' competition. It's that simple. Get to it and enter now – it's FREE.

Some incredible prizes to be won in the Guys and Dolls Challenge





One Stop Automotive Shop

We Service New Cars and you get to keep the Warranty

We offer:
Pink, Green, Blue Slips

SERVICING NEW & OLD VEHICLES

Daniel Blackhall
02 6845 4062 | 0439589 860

onestopautomotiveshop@hotmail.com
36A Gisborne St, Wellington

Wellington Boot Carnival *Featuring the Richest Race in the West* **Friday, April 10 Saturday, April 11**

Featuring an 8-race card and entertained by Tracie, Debbie and Mick

Golf Day - 4-Person Ambrose
Wellington Golf Club

Sunday, April 12

Featuring an 8-race card featuring the \$200,000 Wellington Boot Fashions on the Field - be entertained by Greg Hush

Boot Calcutta
Wellington Soldiers Club 8pm
with Miracle Mal Johnson,
Garry Freeman & Greg Ryan

Introducing the
Tooheys Guys and Dolls Challenge
for 18-30 year-olds
entrants pick one of 14 Boot race
horses - free entry to Boot Sunday,
Lunch and drinks

Contact Wellington Race Club
Phn: 0437 778 451
e: wellingtonboot@wellingtonraceclub.net





Wellington Newsagency

OPENING HOURS
Mon, Tues, Wed, Fri: 6.30am - 5pm
Thur: 6.30am - 5.30pm
Sat: 6.30am - 12.30pm
Sun: 7am - 12 midday
All newspapers available
Don't forget your Lotto's and Powerball
118 Percy Street, Wellington.

**WONDERFUL COFFEE,
BEST TAKEAWAY!**
Call in and say "Hi" to the girls!
Tues - Thurs - 9-4; Fri - 10-8; Sat - 11-4
Closed - Sun & Mon

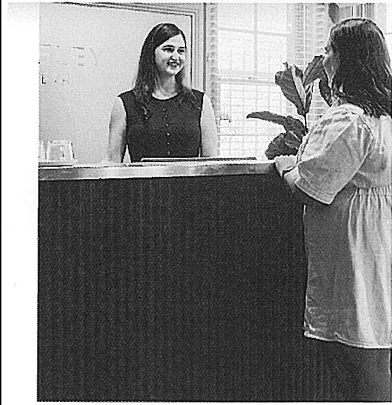
Food 2GO 170 Percy Street
Wellington
02 6845 1211

Wellington Craft
146 PERCY STREET | 7 DAYS A WEEK | 9AM - 4PM WEEKENDS | 10AM - 2PM WEEKENDS

Gifts for Everyone
Individually hand crafted



At Whiteley Optometry we believe that good vision & eye health is essential to full and healthy community living. As a finalist for the Guys and Dolls Contest at the Wellington Boot 2026 we would like to offer you a voucher to purchase your next raceware attire.



56 Bultje Street Dubb NSW 2830 | (02) 6884 407

Sharon Lenton's name is synonymous with thoroughbreds and fashions

BY COLIN HODGES

THE WELLINGTON Boot Carnival is conducted as a very professional event and for that reason Wellington Race Club engages a consummate professional in Sharon Lenton to co-ordinate and judge the Fashions on the Field.

Sharon has filled this role for 10 years and her impartiality as a judge and bubbly personality make this a much-anticipated part of race day.

"Naturally, I have met and made friends with a lot of people at race meetings however I have a self-imposed and strict rule - "I have no friends when a judge," Sharon revealed.

Associates and friends of Sydney based Sharon Lenton often wonder how she manages to fit so much in to a day with this dynamic lady, while working full time, becoming the Founder and owner of three organisations - Thoroughbred Events Australia -The Thoroughbred Club and Thoroughbred Girls.

"From a very early age I have loved horses and then later, horse racing and all the associated events, in both the city and country areas ", Sharon explained.



Sharon Lenton sashing Best Dressd Lady last year.

About 17 years ago Thoroughbred Events Australia was launched by Sharon with a goal to educate more people, particularly women, about horse racing and to offer advice about appropriate dress and millinery for a day at the races (colours, styles etc) whether it be a high profile, casual or fun day event.

Numerous events and fundraisers were staged and meetings held to discuss issues relating to racing and the next step was the establishment of The Thoroughbred Club where the funds raised at events were principally for the welfare of retired racehorses.

"I am passionate about the care and re-training of horses after they finish racing and the first cheque from a fund raiser event was sent to Racing NSW to assist with horse welfare", Sharon said.

Now well established, The Thoroughbred Club sponsors and promotes events around Australia such as small equestrian days, to polo, showjumping and eventing with the focus on giving off the track horses a good and useful life.

Community Awards are also sponsored by The Thoroughbred Club to recognise those contributing their time and expertise for horse welfare.

Third cab off the rank for Sharon Lenton was the establishment of Thoroughbred Girls which gives like-minded women the chance to enjoy eachother's company at race meetings and to experience the thrills of having a share in racehorses.

Starting off with 20 members the number has rapidly expanded and members are encouraged to attend race meetings as a group and share tables, with their motto being "One Team-One Dream".

Friendships are soon formed and when groups of members travel to race meetings in other towns they are often hosted



Sharon Lenton in her role as organiser of Fashions on the Field at the Wellington Boot Sunday. There are some 12 categories to organise for judges during a hectic two hours

in the homes of other members Sharon stressed that Thoroughbred Girls is not a syndicator but members can take small shares in racehorses and last year there was on average a winning horse every two weeks.

An avowed lover of country racing, Sharon Lenton regards the Wellington Boot Carnival as very special and the Wellington Race Club is thrilled to have had her unique services over the past 10 years.

Webb family are keen supporters of Wellington

THE WELLINGTON Boot is a magnet for owners and trainers who often travel long distances to win the famous race including from Sydney, provincial and interstate stables however in 2025 it was a popular result with the winning horse Comongin and connections coming from nearby Dubbo.

Peter and Lou Webb, formerly from Gulargambone and now living at Dubbo, bred and own Comongin which gave trainer

Brett Robb and jockey Clayton Gallagher, both from Dubbo, their first win in a Wellington Boot.

Named after a property near Quilpie in South-West Queensland once owned by the grandfather of Peter Webb, Comongin is the foal of Burbie which apart from nine placings, won a Maiden Handicap when trained by Clint Lundholm and ridden by Daniel Northey for Peter and Lou Webb on Wellington Boot

day in 2014.

Taken to the early lead by Clayton Gallagher in the \$200,000 Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club - Wellington Boot (1100m) Comongin (\$10) sprinted away in the straight and won by over two-lengths from the Bjorn Baker, Warwick trained Alabama Charm (Winaona Costin, \$5.50) and Bullant (Mitch Stapleford, \$13) trained at Scone by Lyle Chandler.

Colin Hodges

Lover of horses and racing for 40+ years

ACCORDING TO Peter Barton, the President of Wellington Race Club, he was hooked on the thrill of winning a race and the dream of owning a good one when 40 years ago, Prudhoe Bay, the first horse he raced was trained by Tim Martin and won twice in Sydney plus three country Cups including the Inverell Cup.

With the 2026 Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club - Wellington Boot fast approaching, Peter Barton is hoping that two horses he has a share in can feature on the day including Harry, bred by long time Wellington Race Club

(WRC) committee member Phillip Thatcher.

Another WRC committee member Bruce Gavin of Cumnock, shares in the ownership of Harry which will race in the colours of the late Peter Fisher also a long-time WRC committee member and Vice-President.

The other horse is Mazort, part owned by WRC committee members Michael and Simone Keirle, Jared Wykes and a few others from Wellington who are hoping the two-year-old can get a start in the Boot.

Along with Harry, Mazort is trained by Brett Thompson and

Peter Barton predicts there will be big celebrations if he can salute the judge.

"I encourage everyone to come along to this year's carnival and be a part of history with the running of the 46th Wellington Boot, the richest race in the west," Peter Barton said.





Wellington Cup back in Peter Milling & Company hands

Peter Milling is remembered with Wellington Cup race

PETER MILLING & Company is pleased to be associated with the Wellington Race Club in sponsoring the Wellington Cup at this year's Wellington Boot Racing Carnival.

The Company has sponsored the Wellington Cup twice in the past, and this year will name the race in honour of the late Peter Milling who was strongly involved in the thoroughbred industry through conducting yearling and mixed sales throughout the Central West and beyond, a history well documented.

But he also had a love of horses especially the thoroughbred and raced several good horses in his time.

He was a strong supporter of country racing and in his heyday would be seen at the track on race day most weekends.

The team at Peter Milling & Company will be in attendance on April 12 and look forward to catching up with clients and racegoers on the day.

As a side note, I have been a winning owner of the Wellington Cup and can attest to the thrill of winning not only your local Cup but any Country Cup race.

Peter Dwyer

Wellington Race Club president Peter Barton with Mack Griffith, and family, Mudgee, among connections of Aimpoint, winner of 2025 Wellington Cup.



Peter Milling & Company Property Sales Manager, Peter Dwyer with the Wellington Cup held in the memory of the late Peter Milling and will be presented to connections of the 1700m race winner while Wellington Race Club committee member Jared Wykes holds one of two replica Boots that will be presented to the jockey and the trainer of the Wellington Boot.

WELLINGTON BOOT RACE WEEKEND

FRIDAY 10
SATURDAY 11
SUNDAY 12
APRIL

The Grand Hotel
Open All Weekend

Bistro Open
12-2 lunch
5.30 - 8.30
Dinner

Food & Drink Specials
All Weekend

Limited accommodation rooms available
Call 6845 1303 for more info.

The Grand Hotel Wellington 111-113 Lee Street.



Jacob and Clair are aiming high in their professions

BY COLIN HODGES

LOCATED ABOUT 50 kms from Wellington, the village of Ballimore has the iconic Hair of the Dog Inn and the monthly Ballimore Auction Sales where you can buy anything from a chook to a motor bike.

Add to the above, Clair Stiff and Jacob Stiff, the offspring of Mandy and Paul Stiff who operate the Pineleigh Poll Dorset

sheep stud on their property at Ballimore.

The 2022 Captain of Macquarie Anglican Grammar School and now a University Honours degree student, Clair Stiff researching Endometrioses, is the 2025 Wellington Show Young Woman titleholder and was recently selected as a Zone 6 Finalist for The Land 2026 Sydney Royal Show Young Woman title.

Apprenticed to Dubbo trainer Michael Mulholland, Jacob Stiff is an outstanding young jockey who despite only starting race riding in late winter last year has already won two of the feature events in the Central West.

In August 2025 he had his first race ride on Firefinch in a Maiden Handicap at Gulargambone and the first winner for Jacob Stiff was on the Mack Griffith, Mudgee trained Dawn County in a 10-horse field on a heavy track at Narromine on 22nd September 2026.

Grenfell was the next meeting after Narromine and Jacob rode a winning double, Obsessive Nature and Phils Colours, both being trained at Parkes by Sharon Jeffries.

First feature race win for Jacob Stiff was in the \$75,000 Robert Oatley-Big Dance Eligibility-Mudgee Cup (1400 metres) on the Cameron Crockett, Scone trained Dances With Hooves (\$15) which jumped from an outside barrier in a big field and from a long way back finished fast to win by a length from Rematch (Aaron Bullock, \$3.80) and Istoleamerc (Winona Costin, \$2.60 favourite).

Riding for his boss Michael Mulholland, Jacob Stiff had his next major win when Shadow Dane (\$11) with a powerful run from well back



Jacob Stiff returns to scales after a race and at right, his sister, Clair a finalist in The Land 2026 Sydney Royal Show Young Woman of the Year.

swept down the outside to beat Mathrin (Adrian Layt, \$31) and Dynamic One (Molly Bourke, \$8) in the 1700m Breakout River Meats-Cowra Cup.

Another highlight for Jacob came in February at Dubbo when he rode a winning treble, Vicious Rumour (\$1.60 fav) and Wing Nut (\$9.50) for Michael Mulholland and Black Nature (\$5) for Dubbo trainer Dar Lunn.

When the fields thunder in to the home straight at the Wellington Boot Carnival there will be plenty of cheering from the many fans of Jacob Stiff, the quiet natured and very well liked, talented young jockey from Ballimore.





The Mallee Hen's Nest

Quality and used furniture, clothes, gifts and homewares

Open 8am to 1pm
Breakfast & Lunch available
ALL BOOT WEEKEND!



themallee hens nest@outlook.com
14-18 Lee Street | 02 6845 4595

CAVES WOOD GALLERY AND GIFTS

83 Caves Road, Wellington, NSW 2820
...on the road to Wellington Caves...

02 6845 4319

caveswoodgallery@gmail.com

Ken 0412 497 097 or Chris 0407 736 531

UNIQUE HANDCRAFTED GIFTS!

Boots on the ground,
numbers in check,
Ess Tee accounting
proudly supports

The 2026 Wellington Boot





Race club committee's Mr Fix it - Jared Wykes

SPORTING AND other organisations in country towns invariably rely on those willing to volunteer a generous slice of their time for the benefit of the community.

In that category is the very well-liked Jared Wykes, a local electrician who apart from being a valued committee member of the Wellington Race Club has also been a hard worker for other organisations. With two others, Jared was a founder of the Twin Rivers Fishing Club with events based around Lake Burrendong, the Bell and Macquarie rivers.

"From the start the Fishing club was focused on family involvement with adults and children learning about and enjoying a great outdoor activity," Jared said.

A talented sportsman, Jared Wykes was in the Wellington High 10-aside-All-Stars team which defeated several of the big schools in Sydney before winning the Final against Granville High.

He and team mates then had the thrill of playing in a curtain raiser for a Brumbys/Waratah game at the Sydney Football Stadium.

Later to become the President of the Wellington Rugby Union Club, Jared as a winger with the Redbacks won a Central West competition when beating Geurie Goats in the

Grand Final and he then played the occasional game until 2019.

In 2014, Jared joined the committee of Wellington Race Club after being approached by the then club president, the popular and much-admired Ian Darney.

An exciting time for Jared was when he won a Wellington Boot raffle, the prize being a yearling filly, later named Tennessee Pasha and the subsequent winner of two races at Wellington along with several placings.

With other committee members, Jared is a part-owner of the two-year-old Mazort which they hope can get a start in the Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club - Wellington Boot.

"Very few people would realise how much time Jared Wykes puts in for the club as most days after work he is out at the track doing various things relevant to the upkeep of the racecourse," revealed club president Peter Barton.

Michael and Simone Keirle also explained how Jared Wykes makes himself available to accept phone calls throughout the week to answer general enquiries.

"Jared Wykes is a terrific person and it is a great asset to have him on the Wellington Race Club committee", was the joint comment from Michael and Simone Keirle.



E: esstee131a@gmail.com

P: 02 6845 3985

M: 0448 844 009

8 Nanima Crescent

PO Box 193

Wellington. NSW. 2820.

TAN: 248 692 37



Making a dominant name in racing

BY COLIN HODGES

LIKELY TO have a sizeable number racing at the Wellington Boot Carnival is trainer Brett Thompson who has high regard for the Wellington committee and the Wellington track where he works several of his big team of gallopers.

A former shearer, shearing contractor, farmer and publican, Brett Thompson decided to have a crack at being a race-horse trainer and purchased his first horse, Hewentwhoosh for \$4,500 at the Scone Yearling Sales in 2009.

The new career was off to a great start when Hewentwhoosh won the rich 2YO Inglis Challenge at Scone and much, much later the grand galloper was retired at 10 years of age after 101 starts which yielded 14 wins and 30 placings and prizemoney of \$257,745.

There have since been a multitude of winners from the Thompson stable with one highlight being the performances of Slate On Edge which Brett gave the nickname "The Gulgong Grey" in respect of the "Goondiwindi Grey", the famous Gunsynd.

Travelling interstate, Brett Thompson twice won the Grey Series (2014 and 2015) with Slate On Edge at the Melbourne Spring Carnivals with the wins including on Manikato Stakes Night (2014) at Moonee Valley and on Oaks Day (2015) at Flemington.

Especially satisfying for Brett Thompson was landing the quinella with More Than Art (Billy Cray) and Attalea (James Rogers) in his hometown 2018 Oatley Fine Wines-Gulgong Cup, with both jockeys being formerly from England.



Snapped during a break in trackwork at Wellington racecourse are Jay and Kurt Thompson and their father, local trainer Brett Thompson with Jake Pracey-Holmes who started as Brett's apprentice 13 years ago.

The successful career of Brett Thompson has included winning the Central Districts Trainers Premiership on five successive occasions from 2012, twice winning the Western Racing Association Premiership and winning the NSW Country Trainer 'Trainer Of The Year' in 2016 and being the runner up in 2017.

While there are other long standing and valued members of the staff, the family of Brett Thompson are heavily involved including Brett's sons, Ben, Kurt and Jay.

Ben Thompson is the horse breaker and trackwork rider, Kurt Thompson is stable foreman and Jay Thompson rides trackwork and helps Ben with the breaking.

Brett's wife Kelly Thompson is always ready to help at the stable while their daughter Nikki helps when she can find the time while raising a family.

All the above stemmed from Brett's parents Percy Thompson and Diane Thompson who have been involved in racing for many years, Percy Thompson being a former successful trainer and the long-standing president of Gulgong Turf Club and Diane Thompson the long-standing secretary of the club.



Jockey Challenge in memory of Nigel Tolhurst in it's third year



The Nigel Tolhurst Memorial (*Clerk of the Scales*) Jockey Challenge is again offering \$3500 prize-money for the jockeys who ride the most winners over the two-day Wellington Boot Carnival. Last year Clayton Gallagher was the winner with Braith Knock second and Tilly McCarroll third. They are with Miracle Mal Johnston and Halle and Sharon Tolhurst.

Styled by Sim

Why not a Boot makeover?
Simone McManus
Suite 1
36-42 Swift St
Wellington
02 6845 1976

Cusack's Butchery

**No Hors'ing around
Cusack's Butchery
only offers quality
Beef, Lamb,
Pork and Poultry**

60 Lee St, Wellington
PH: 02 6845 1350
A.H. 02 6845 2166 or Mob: 0418 668 162

Offering all day Breakfast, fresh juice and Jespresso's own signature coffee blends

Open 6 days Mon – Fri 5am to 2pm,
Sat – 5am to 12pm, Sun – Closed

**Call in at 56 Lee Street
Jespresso Coffee
(02) 5824 3804**

COW & CALF

WELLINGTON NSW 0268452710

Join us at the Cow & Calf This Wellington Boot Weekend

Entertainment	10th-12th April 2026	Food
Friday 10 th : Riff Raff Band Saturday 11 th : Bousa Sunday 12 th : Pete & Shane Riley Entertainment	Open 11am - til late Cow and Calf Good Food & Drink	Kitchen serving from 12-2pm / 5.30-8.30pm Perfect refuel after a day at the races Accommodation

Wellington & District
LEADER

Are you up for the challenge?

Wellington Boot 2026
TOOHEYS
 GUYS AND DOLLS
 CHALLENGE

Find details on our website:
WWW.WELLINGTONSOLDIERS.COM.AU

Wellington & District
LEADER

WELLINGTON BOOT
Calcutta

SATURDAY 11TH APRIL

FEATURING
 Malcolm "Miracle" Johnston,
 Gary "Whiz" Freeman and Greg Ryan.

\$2
 TICKET

ON SALE FROM 6PM | CALCUTTA STARTS 8PM

FOLLOWED BY
DJ TJ SIMPSON

STARTS: 7:30PM
PARTY UNTIL LATE

LAST STAND
CHISEL BARNES SHOW
FRIDAY 10TH APRIL

PLUS
 the 92
 Rock
 Show

Boot
 Weekend

A TRIBUTE TO
COLD CHISEL & JIMMY BARNES

WELLINGTON BOOT WEEKEND

4-PERSON
AMBROSE

SATURDAY 11TH APRIL

TEES OPEN 8AM

Play golf alongside sporting legends,
 NRL great **Gary Freeman** and racing's
 Malcolm "Miracle" Johnston.

\$1,500 IN PRIZES!

The Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club Courtesy Bus
 will provide shuttle services between the venues on the day.

WELLINGTON
BOOT RACES

SUNDAY 12TH APRIL

GREG HUSH
 FROM 1PM

Insert the missing letters to make 10 words – five reading across the grid and five reading down.

L		S		S
	D		O	
F		R		O
	R		A	
S		N		E

Place each of the tiles of letters into the blank jigsaw below to create four six-letter words going across and down.

TY

SH

IF

ON

UR

RI

NE

CO

There may be more than one possible answer.

Insert each number from 1 to 9 in the shaded squares to solve all the horizontal and vertical equations. Multiplication and division are performed before addition and subtraction.

+

+

=

20

-

×

÷

=

35

+

-

+

=

48

×

×

=

41

=

=

=

5

7

41

5

Solutions

EDGECROSSWORD

E

S

N

E

S

T

A

R

T

O

G

R

O

F

W

O

I

D

I

S

T

S

T

L

5X5

S

14

7

=

=

=

84

=

2

×

4

×

9

+

-

+

35

=

1

+

5

×

7

+

×

-

02

=

3

+

6

+

8

11X5CROSSWORD

27-03-26 | PUZZLES AND PAGINATION © pagemasters.

WELLINGTON & DISTRICT LEADER, THURSDAY, MARCH 26, 2026, 17

'ONE STOP SHOP' DIRECTORY



Peter Milling & Company
— Livestock & Property Agents —

Are you thinking of selling
your home?

Contact Rebecca at Peter Milling &
Company and see why she was awarded
the #1 agent of the year 6 years running!



Rebecca Harding
Residential Sales Manager

P: 02 6845 1555
M: 0457 517 444

**DOMESTIC
WATER
DELIVERIES**



Servicing
**WELLINGTON
& REGION**

Fiona: 0427 463 441
Ken: 0427 463 442



**PATHWAY
TO
POTENTIAL**
SUPPORT SERVICE

NDIS SUPPORT PROVIDER
SERVICING DUBBO, WELLINGTON
& NARROMINE NSW

CONTACT US

pathwaytopotential.com.au

Our Socials



ARE YOU OR SOMEONE
YOU KNOW LOOKING FOR A
DISABILITY PROVIDER?





REDFERN
HEAVY DIESEL

FOR ALL YOUR DIESEL NEEDS
Servicing Wellington & surrounding areas.

BART: 0427 724 788

Lc No:
MVRL 60819



**JUST
HANG
IT**

HAND-MADE BY SHARON WILSON
0407 935 998
Check out my facebook page



T & N
AUTO & AG SERVICES

For all mechanical needs

Car & 4wd Servicing
(new & old)
Road Worthy Inspection
Mechanical Repairs
Wheel Alignment
and Much More

Phn: 02 68 45 1112 92 Lee Street
0488 660 776 WELLINGTON

Is your business missing?
We can fix that!

Get your business in front of new customers

Phone Sharon on 0407 935 998

Raine&Horne.
Wellington

Residential, Commercial & Rural Sales
Latest Sales Marketing Technology
Personalised Service Tailored To Your Property Needs

Call 0428 459 830
Email gary.francis@wellington.rh.com.au

Gary Francis Multiple Recipient of Raine & Horne's
Prestigious Chairmans Club Awards



Scan the QR code
on your phone or device
to view our new website

Wellington & District
LEADER





AGRI TOPICS

Information for the
Man on the Land

**For More Information
call**



Mb: 0428 635 994

ANOTHER WEEK of mostly hot dry conditions. The good news is this week will be much cooler with a chance of some rainfall on Monday 23rd

Following drought conditions, areas that receive fresh rain can trigger a flush of lush, rapidly growing pasture, particularly legumes. While the green feed looks ideal, it can dramatically increase the risk of rumen bloat in sheep and cattle.

Bloat occurs when gas produced during rumen fermentation becomes trapped in a stable foam, preventing the animal from releasing it naturally. The result can be rapid swelling of the rumen and, if not managed early animal losses will occur. Prevention is always the best strategy. APVMA approved supplement block “bloat-lick” is designed to help control bloat by acting as an anti-foaming agent in the rumen, helping livestock release asses.

This week AGSAFE is set to launch the first Product Stewardship Week (March 16 to 22) a national digital only initiative dedicated to highlighting the important role stewardship plays across Australian agriculture.

Throughout the week, they will be sharing stories and examples that demonstrate how industry is working together to support responsible product management from innovation and safe use through to recovery and recycling. Product stewardship week is designed to bring greater visibility to the practical work already happening across the sector and to recognise the organisations helping drive meaningful environmental and industry outcomes.

Because of the war in the Middle East when purchasing your fertiliser especially MAP you may notice differing product colour being lighter, because of new sourcing, this fertiliser meets the same standard.

Markets at a glance

WOOL 10th. EMI lost 48c closing 1517c/kg cln. Sydney. All MPGs down 17 to 69c, further falls on day2 especially the finer end. Merino skirtings firm for lots carrying low vm, (<5%) anything higher softened. XB softer day1 slipping 20 to 30c day2. NRI 1554c/kg (-53c) Sydney pass in rate 15.8% with 654 bales withdrawn. Mer cardings indicator up 6c to 829n c/kg clean.

CATTLE. CTLX. 2520, -1517. Young trade cattle lifted 20c and more in places. Yearling steers 440c to 513c, heifers 380c to 487c/kg. Feeder steers 15c dearer, 450c to 538c, heifers slipped 3c to 487c/kg. Light steers to restockers to 551c, heifers to 445c/kg. Grown cattle gained 20, heavy steers 386c to 478c, heifers 390c to 488c/kg. Cows firm, 2 and 3 scores 298c to 390c. Heavy cows 376c to 412c/kg, bulls to 424c/kg.

SHEEP. CTLX 11th. 2358 sheep (+283,) lambs 6147 (+1602). Light lambs sought after by restockers, little going to processors. Trade lambs 20kg to 24kg firm to dearer, \$248 to \$298. Heavy lambs steady, 24 to 26kg \$275 to \$316, up to 30kg \$315to \$347. Carcase price ave 1180c and 1240c/kg cwt. Lambs to restockers to \$266, heavy hoggets to \$280.

MUTTON. Mixed quality, prices remaining strong. Merno ewes \$148 to \$237, XB ewes \$152 to \$306. Merino wethers \$120 to \$188, heavy Dorper rams to \$210. Most ranged 840c to 880c/kg cwt.

SHOP STOCK CLEARANCE: as the shed is sold all stock must go. Fertilisers, seed, ag chem, drench, dips, poly pipe, small packs and shelving, large Avery scales as new, lots of antiques

Rural



Plasto & Company

Livestock and Property

Stock report by Ross Plasto

DUBBO CATTLE. 8500, up 800. Numbers keep pouring in. Again, large numbers of cows and young calves as growers continue to sell off due to the drying conditions. Few young trade cattle 10c dearer, yearlings 444c to 504c/kg. Feeder steers and lightweight heifers 6c to 12c cheaper, heavier feeder heifers 10c/kg dearer. Feeder steers 440c to 522c, heifers 365c to 476c/kg. Young restocker cattle 30c to 50c cheaper. Young steers to 570c, heifers to 454c/kg, ave considerably lower than previous sales. Grown steers and heifers firm. Grown steers 426c to 488c, heifers 435c to 475c/kg. Cows 15c to 18c cheaper. Two and 3 scores to processors 220c to 380c/kg. Heavy cows 368c to 398c, ave 385c/kg. Cows to restockers 150c to 422c/kg. Heavy bulls to 442c/kg.

DUBBO LAMB. 20,000. Plainier yarding with influx of light Dorpers. Trade weights in good numbers but less heavy and extra heavy lambs. Restockers took up increase in light lamb short skinned lambs preferred. Overall, restocking lambs dearer, short skins firm, rest cheaper. Restocking lambs to 18kg \$15 dearer at heavier end, \$116 to \$217. Trade lambs were firm to \$3 softer, 20 to 24kg \$230 to \$277, ave 1100c to 1130c/kg, 24 to 26kg \$248 to \$296, ave 1080c/kg. Heavy lambs back \$10, \$287 to \$326, extra heavy \$339 to \$393, ave 1060c/kg cwt. Best hogget to \$326/head.

MUTTON. Numbers eased, quality

mixed. Prices firm to dearer, especially light mutton. Medium ewes \$145 to \$235. Heavy crossbred ewes to \$328, Merinos \$289, most averaged 770c and 830c/kg cwt.

WOOL. As explained last week, the Northern region had outperformed the rest of the country. last week saw the three national selling centres attempt to realign on prices. It still has not fully rectified anomalies, especially for anything broader than 19-micron. To put that into perspective the 20-micron indicator is the example used this week – North minus 126 cents, South minus 40 cents, West minus 84 cents. Who is right or wrong should sort itself out this week however the concern is the Western region continued to accelerate losses on the final day after the Eastern seaboard selling had closed. Whilst last week’s losses are unwelcome it does come after a fortnight of fending off global headwinds, and we still have a market 45.5% higher (on average) than what we started the season at in July. Passed-in rates climbed as the losses grew to exceed the seasonal average and highlighting the struggle in the West, it was near on a quarter of the offering failing to be sold. 36,572 bales were sold nationally for the week with 13.5% passed in. Major buyers included Techwool, PJ Morris and Sequoia. Upcoming offerings remain stubbornly above 40,000 bales weekly but that will become a changing feast based on market movements.



Dubbo (02) 6885 0549



Wellington 0427 919 062

WEEKLY MARKET REPORT

Week ending March 20, 2026

AWEX Northern Micron Indices Comparison

AWEX INDEX	This Week 3/8/25	This Week 3/18/25	Last Sale 3/5/25	Spring Change	Last Year Spring	Spring Year Change
ST	2576	2962	2408	-42	3791	+643
SB	2937	3313	2373	-36	5633	+764
SB	2178	2173	2250	-36	3558	+625
20	2050n	2062	2136n	-126	1508n	+582
21	-	2048n	-	-	-	-
26	827n	865	898	-32	602n	+225
26	665n	658	688n	-23	475n	+240
NAC	1008n	3946	1029n	+8	738n	+299

Larger offerings halt price gains

THE SENTIMENT of a softer market from the prior week came to fruition, with the wool market unable to continue on its upward trajectory, recording losses in all three selling centres. It was the medium and broader Merino fleece that fell the greatest, giving back between 76 to 126 cents in the North and the West, whilst in the South the falls ranged from 36 to 58 cents, having sold in isolation and experiencing the market weakness prior to this week’s sales. Tuesday was more affected than Wednesday’s sale, with the EMI cheaper by 22 cents, followed by 10 cents on the second day. Interestingly, in US terms on Wednesday there was no change. Skirtings defied the cheaper trend throughout, generally holding firm or showing slight improvement in the free broken lines in the finer end. Crossbreds fell around 20 cents, and cardings had a mixed result, being stronger in Sydney, no change in Melbourne, but 45c cheaper in Fremantle. Good prices have encouraged more wool into the market in the past two months, with 40,000 bales average each week. Buyers tell us that the consistency of the volume has given top makers a little breathing space in the past couple of weeks, and as much as we love to see prices go up week after week, there comes a stage where these mills can’t make the averages continue to work. That said, last week’s market result doesn’t signal an underlying shift in demand, rather consolidation of recent gains. No doubt there could be some retracement of price over the coming sales, but buyers believe there will be vastly smaller offerings around May, which could lead to another price surge similar to the one post Christmas. After last year’s success at raising enough money to fit out two new rooms at Macquarie Home Stay, Endeavour Wool Exports and Macdonald and Co are again hoping to raise \$70,000 for the next stage being built. Our clients were extremely generous with their donations of bags, butts or bales, and we are hoping to replicate that achievement this year. Please let us know if you would like to be part of the fundraising for this great community facility. This week Macwool and Carmichael wool offered 700 bales yesterday, with the three selling centres operating around a total of almost 41,000 bales.

YOUR WOOL IN SAFE HANDS







Are you up for the challenge?

Wellington Boot 2026

TOOHEYS

GUYS AND DOLLS

CHALLENGE

Fun time at the Boot - and it’s free

Join the fun and become a challenger in the Guys and Dolls Challenge during the 2026 Wellington Boot Racing Carnival weekend.

All you have to do is – turn up!
Attend the Boot Calcutta night at the Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club from 6pm in the auditorium Saturday, April 11, and if your name is drawn, you can draw a horse in the Wellington Boot race on Sunday 12th, gain free entry to the racecourse, enjoy a free lavish lunch and drinks throughout the day in the Wellington Race Club sponsors tent - all courtesy of Tooheys, Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club, *Wellington & District Leader*, Eliza Whiteley Optometry and Wellington Race Club.

The 2026 Wellington Boot racing Carnival runs with an eight-race program on Friday, April 10 with \$10 admission on Friday.

The Boot Classic Golf Day at Wellington Golf Club runs on Saturday, then the Boot Calcutta on Saturday night with guest host Miracle Mal Johnson, the legend of racing.

Sunday is Boot day, the richest race over the great divide (bar Scone).

Gates open 11am and \$20 admission Sunday for everyone else without tickets.

Guys and Dolls Challenge
Fill-in an entry form at Wellington Soldiers memorial Club or club website.

You must be aged 18 to 30 years.
Attend the Wellington Boot Calcutta on Saturday night April 10.

Gain free entry to Sunday’s Boot race meeting, enjoy lunch and drinks all day at the Wellington Race Club sponsor’s tent.

Each Challenger will receive a 2026 Wellington Boot Guys and Dolls sash to keep and wear forever.

How it works

There are 14 runners in the 2026 Wellington Boot race.

On Saturday night at Calcutta, entry forms will be drawn from a barrel and the person nominated must be at the Calcutta.

That person then draws a horse in the Boot race.

UP to 14 people will drawn. If there are horse scratchings, then only Guys and Dolls with remaining horses are eligible to win the First, Second or Third prizes available, which will be presented to the drawers of those placed horses.

Dress-up for the day, and you may like to also enter ‘Fashions on the Field’ competition.
It’s that simple.
Get to it and enter now – it’s FREE.

...Continued from Back Page.

Kiss Trophy results from Round 1: B Kiss v Bye, W Bruce defeated R Cowan, R Baker defeated Rod McMahon, David O’Brien defeated Brock Naden, P Neuenhaus defeated D Stone, P West defeated D East, D Bell defeated Pat Slack-Smith, Norm Royal defeated Rod Irwin, B Eather defeated v Wayne Lang, Kurt Cusack v Bye, J Barton defeated M Cornish, C Royal defeated M Ringland, Rod Miller defeated Rod Pedron, John Gersbach defeated Nathan Stewart, N Stanford defeated G Hollow, D Naveau defeated M Payne, J Bullock v D Hyde to be finalised, K Reid v Bye, D Ney v Daniel McCullum to be finalised, Tim Parker defeated R Parnell, A Ryan defeated P Holden, S Whiteman defeated Conn, Elton Keeffe defeated D Haesler, J Ryan v Bye, D Wilson defeated J Donnelly, W Slack-Smith defeated A Brien, A

Bullock defeated J Fleming, R Agar defeated J Armstrong, G McNaughton defeated L Conn, Gary Cusack defeated M Britton, J Southwell defeated D Ryan, S Kiss v Bye.
Round 2 matches Kiss Trophy: B Kiss v W Bruce, R Baker v D O’Brien, P Neuenhaus v P West, D Bell v N Royal, B Eather v K Cusack, J Barton v C Royal, R Miller v J Gersbach, N Stanford v D Naveau, K Reid v Bullock or Hyde, T Parker v Ney or McCullum, A Ryan v S Whiteman, E Keeffe v J Ryan, D Wilson v W Slack-Smith, A Bullock v R Agar, G McNaughton v G Cusack, J Southwell v S Kiss.
This Saturday and Sunday will see the Cusack’s Butchery Men’s Foursomes Championships in conjunction with an Individual Stableford for those not playing in the Foursomes.
A few date changes for events to be finalised, J and B Cup Round 1 to be finalised by April 25, Kiss Trophy Round 2 matches by April 18.
19th Hole



Cathy Loo-Shui, Anita Medcalf, President WGNSW being presented the Joyce Henderson Trophy.

Lucy’s local library study experience ends up on display at Mitchell Library

Wellington’s Lucy Keirle, chose Wellington Library for her university industry placement late last year, and was chosen to be featured in a signature display at the State Library of NSW in celebration of the library’s 200th anniversary.
Images and stories of library users from 65 libraries across regional NSW and Sydney, were commissioned for the anniversary, and are displayed at the Library’s outdoors on the Macquarie Street forecourt in Sydney.
It was part of the statewide ‘Library That Made Me’ year-long campaign celebrating the power of libraries and their enduring place in the hearts of communities across the state, and seeking and sharing stories of libraries that have made a difference in people’s lives.
Photos of other local Library “stars”, Jim Titley, Susan Atkinson and Margot Drake also appear in a wider online exhibition.
If you would like to share your own story of the library - or libraries - that have made a difference in your life, go to shareyour-story.sl.nsw.gov.au
One of the Library computers will also be set aside for this purpose.
Pop in to the Wellington Library during March to view Lucy’s photo and story.



Lucy Keirle outside Wellington Library. She is featured in the state library’s ‘Library That Made Me’ campaign.

Top five fiction titles borrowed so far this year:

- The Healers – Ann Cleeves
 - Exiles – Jane Harper
 - The secret – Lee Child
 - Nightshade – Michael Connelly
 - Great big beautiful life – Emily Henry
- Borrow or reserve a copy today.

New height-adjustable accessible computer desk

Make yourself comfortable at our new accessible computer desk.
With just the touch of a button the desk can be raised to accommodate a wheelchair or mobility scooter – or serve as a standing workstation.

Join us on Tuesday 31 March - Fun and games for the young at heart

For a morning of fun with board games, memory games, word games, Lego challenges, brainteasers or a bean bag toss.
Try one or try them all!
10.30am to 12pm. Contact Wellington Library to book. Morning tea provided.



Jim Titley and Margot Drake select books from the Wellington Library shelves.

More than fixing things

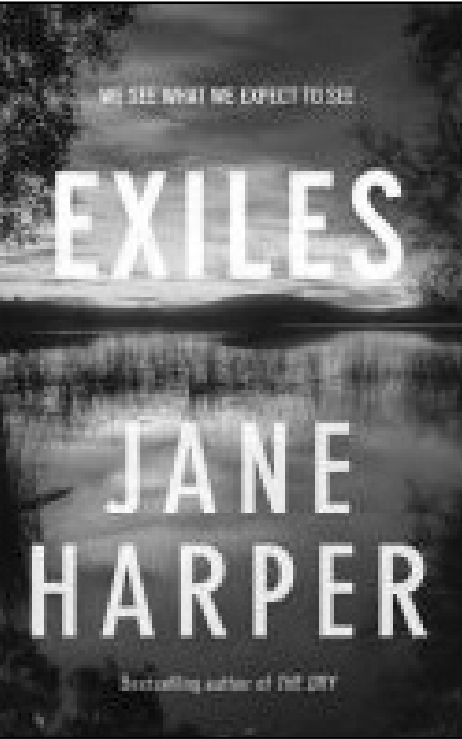
AMONG THE many things the Men’s Shed do we also try to get involved in community events.
Last Saturday the Central West Cycle Trail committee conducted a 42km loop ride from Goolma via the 12 Mile Road and if cyclists were up to it they could do it twice.
Dave Ryan (president) and Jim Titley represented the Wellington Men’s Shed, and they put in a sterling effort and had a great ride.
“We do more than fix things,” Jim said.



In Their Sights

Fashions Mount Rifle Club
Results of Saturday, March 21.
Hunting Class: R. Dowton 99.11, S. King 98.11, S. Barnes 84.3,
L. Hough 84, D. Gollan 79, B. Spedding 53.
500 yards: S. King 112.3, L. Hough 107.3, D. Gollan 105.
Next Shoot: Saturday, April 4 at 900 Yards.
The Rifleman

The Big 5



Junior Rugby Gulargambone Friendship Day

- Carmen Gain photos



Swim Pointscore - second last week

- Carmen Gain Photos



Golfing News

John Gersbach hits a hole-in-one

A HOLE-IN-ONE and the Ladies Open were features of the past week on the course.

It may have taken many years, (58 that is) but last Saturday John Gersbach finally scored a hole-in-one on the eighth.

He becomes one of the legends to win the JKD Carpentry and Pest Control trophy.

On Sunday the Bulabul Battery AMPYR Ladies Wellington Open was conducted with Division 1 winner, Jenny Dresser from Cowra with a 91 off the stick.

Division 2, Dallawong Cup went to Kathy Martin with a 98 off the stick while Division 3, Joyce Henderson Trophy went to Cathy Loo-Shui with a 98 off the stick.

Cathy also claimed the Nett score prize as well with a 69.

Many thanks to all who assisted throughout the day and evening and to our green staff on having the course in great order after Saturday night's storm.

Last Saturday's event was an Individual Stableford won by Mitchell Cusack in A grade. He finished with a 68nett on a countback, welcome back.

Runner-up was Nathan Stewart also on 68nett.

Winner in B grade was Ashley Bullock who compiled a great score of 66nett, while Ben Kiss was runner-up on 69nett.

Prize winners were Paul Hannelly, Peter Holden 69nett; Elton Keeffe, David Naveau, Jeremy Barton 70nett; Paul West, Allison Brien 71nett; Blake Ferguson, Malcolm Payne, John Gersbach 73nett.

Nearest the pin on 3rd Steve Kiss, 8th John Gersbach, 14th Kieran Baker, 16th Mitchell Cusack. NTP in two-shots on 7th went to Kurt Cusack. Longest drives went to

Joe Ryan in A grade and Blake Ferguson in B grade.

Brent Eather Encouragement award was taken out by Brad Conn with an 88nett.

The Garry McNaughton Eagles Nest is back to 1 after the hole in one.

Wednesday's Ladies play a Stroke event, and Round 1 of the WGNWS plus the 9-hole competition.

Winner was Denise Haesler playing extremely well to come away with a 66nett. Marg Hollow was runner-up with 70nett.o also had a good day out to finish with a 70nett. Prize winner Kathy Martin 72nett.

Round 1 winners of the WGNWS Division 1, Denise Haesler, Division 2, Marg Hollow, Division 3, Noella Baker.

Thursday's Individual Stableford winner was Steven McCarroll who cleaned the field with 39pts. Runner-up was Peter Neuenhaus with 36pts on c/b.

Prize winners were Joe Ryan, Brian Smith from Nudgee Golf Club 35pts; Peter Holden 34pts on c/b.

Iberdrola Windfarm - Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club 9-hole competition results from the final week had Rod Irwin claim the win with a 32nett.

Runner up was Brock Naden with 33nett.

The Final Leaderboard had Joe Ryan claiming the winner's prize with a -16, Adam Ryan finished runner-up with -15, Gary McCarroll came in third with -13.

Presentation night will kick off about 6pm with a Putting Competition prior to a Dinner

J and B Cup Finals, Matchplay Championships: A grade, Kurt Cusack v David O'Brien, Mitchell Cusack or David East v John Gersbach, John Donnelly v Mathew Redfern,



John Gersbach was all smiles after his hole-in-one.

Elton Keeffe v Gary Cusack.

B grade, David Hyde v Daniel McCullum, Rod McMahon v Wayne Lang, Steven McCarroll v Tim Parker, Noel Stanford v Stephen Whiteman.

C grade, Rod Irwin v bye, Warren Williams v John Southwell, Drew Stone v bye, Cody Conn v Ron Cowan.

... Continued on Page 21.

Join us for the famous
WELLINGTON BOOT CALCUTTA!

SATURDAY 11TH APRIL 2026

AT WELLINGTON SOLDIERS CLUB
TICKETS ON SALE 6PM
FOLLOWED BY
DJ TJ SIMPSON

YOU WIN SOME, YOU LOSE MORE. FOR FREE AND CONFIDENTIAL SUPPORT VISIT GAMBLING.HELPONLINE.ORG.AU

Wellington
Soldiers Memorial Club Ltd

NOTICE OF THE 2026 ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING AND ELECTION OF OFFICE BEARERS

Notice is hereby given, that the Annual General Meeting of the Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club Limited will be held on **Tuesday 20th April 2026** commencing at the hour of 7.30pm on the premises of the Club, 75 Arthur Street, Wellington, New South Wales.

Nominations for election to one vacant position on the board will be open from 13th April 10.30AM 2026 and will close at 6.00pm 18th April 2026. Nomination forms will be available from the Secretary's office at the Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club during the hours of 10.30am to 5.00pm Monday to Friday. The Secretary shall post the name of the candidates and their proposers on the Club Notice Board within 48 hours of the close of nominations.

Any member wishing to raise an item in general business is requested to give written notice of the nature of that business to the Chief Executive Officer at least ten (10) days prior to the Annual General Meeting.

A copy of the 2026 Annual Account is available on the website OR collection from Reception from 2nd April, 2026.

Dated: 12 March 2024

Secretary Manager

A.B.N: 52 000 877 801

STATEMENT OF PROFIT OR LOSS AND OTHER COMPREHENSIVE INCOME FOR THE YEAR ENDED 31 DECEMBER 2023

By Direction of the Board:

IT PAYS TO BE A MEMBER!

MEMBERS EXCLUSIVE
HOME APPLIANCE GIVEAWAY

PLUS **\$500 CASH!**

We're giving away \$4,500 worth of appliances PLUS \$500 cash!

Just swipe your card when purchasing drinks or playing the pokies to go in the draw.

Automatic entries Must be in the Club to win

Join now and swipe your way to a home upgrade!

Finishes 6pm Sunday 31 May

CLUBS & COMMUNITY AWARDS
2024
WINNER
Wellington Soldiers Club

Gamble Help is close at hand Gambleaware.nsw.gov.au | 1800 858858 | gambleaware.nsw.gov.au

ARTHUR STREET, WELLINGTON | **INFORMATION FOR MEMBERS AND THEIR GUEST**

6845 2877

CRAIG DEAN

Performing Rock Hits from 1955 to 2005
at the Club
SATURDAY 28TH MARCH
7:30pm

MEGA
\$2,000 WORTH OF EASTER EGGS TO RAFFLE
EASTER EGG RAFFLE
TICKETS ON SALE 6PM
SUNDAY 29 MARCH